

ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III

THE COMPLETE EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM

Crèche • Nursery • Reception
Curriculum Foundations • Termly Curriculum • Implementation & Pedagogy

FINAL MASTER EDITION — VERSION 1.0

Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Academic Session: 2026/2027

Framework: British EYFS • Montessori-Informed Practice • Nigerian Context • Christian Character

Motto: In God We Trust

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

Master Volume Statement

Volume III is the official AMES Early Years curriculum and implementation volume for Crèche, Nursery and Reception. It brings together the approved curriculum foundations, the complete three-term curriculum progression for each phase, the Reception-to-Basic-1 transition framework, and the operational pedagogy and implementation tools used by Angel Montessori School.

The volume preserves the developmental principle that Early Years education is ambitious without premature formalisation. It is British in framework, Montessori-informed in practice, Nigerian in context and Christian in character.

The master edition incorporates the final audit corrections: Part I approval, harmonised AMES assessment terminology, clarified England/Nigeria status of the Early Learning Goals, restoration of the fuller approved Part V Chapter 1 substance, and redesigned implementation templates.

Master Document Register

Section	Document	Version	Pages
1	Part I — Curriculum Foundations	1.0	9
2	Part II — Crèche First Term	1.0	6
3	Part II — Crèche Second Term	1.0	6
4	Part II — Crèche Third Term	1.0	7
5	Part III — Nursery First Term	1.0	6
6	Part III — Nursery Second Term	1.0	6
7	Part III — Nursery Third Term	1.0	7
8	Part IV — Reception First Term	1.0	6
9	Part IV — Reception Second Term	1.0	6
10	Part IV — Reception Third Term (Audit Corrected)	1.1	4
11	Part V — Curriculum Implementation & Pedagogy (Revised Master)	1.1	33

Approved source documents: 11 Source-document pages: 96

Final Master Audit & Approval Record

Audit Area	Result	Finding
Document completeness	PASS	Part I; Crèche Terms 1–3; Nursery Terms 1–3; Reception Terms 1–3; Part V present.
Progression continuity	PASS	Crèche -> Nursery -> Reception -> Basic 1 sequence is coherent.
EYFS integrity	PASS	Seven areas retained; Reception remains Early Years; premature formalisation explicitly rejected.
Literacy / phonics	PASS	Oral-language and phonological foundations precede Reception SSP; matched decodables and rich literature retained.
Mathematics	PASS	Experience/manipulation progresses to representation, reasoning and application.
Practical Life / independence	PASS	Progression is explicit from supported participation to greater responsibility.
Assessment terminology	PASS	Overarching KNOW -> PLAN -> TEACH -> OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND -> REVIEW; focused on learning.
EYFS / ELG legal wording	PASS	ELGs identified as statutory within England's EYFS; AMES adoption in Nigeria described as a British-system reference.
Inclusion / SEND / multilingual	PASS	Access, adaptation and home-language principles remain consistent.
Nigerian / African contextualisation	PASS	Owo -> Nigeria -> Africa -> wider world progression retained.
Christian character	PASS	Values are integrated through modelling and lived practice.
Reception -> Basic 1 transition	PASS	Transition is explicit without converting Reception into Basic 1.
Part V compilation	PASS	Revised v1.1 used; fuller Chapter 1 restored and templates redesigned.
Duplicate / obsolete files	PASS	Older Part V v1.0 and Reception T3 v1.0 excluded from master compilation.

FINAL AUDIT RESULT: PASSED

APPROVED FOR MASTER RELEASE

Document Control

Series: Angel Montessori Education System (AMES)

Volume: III — The Complete Early Years Curriculum

Master Version: 1.0

Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Academic Session: 2026/2027

Coverage: Crèche -> Nursery -> Reception -> Basic 1 Transition

Master Release Basis: Approved source PDFs with final audit-corrected Reception Third Term v1.1 and Part V v1.1.

ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III

THE COMPLETE EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM

PART I

CURRICULUM FOUNDATIONS

Crèche • Nursery • Reception
British EYFS • Montessori-Informed Practice • Nigerian Context • Christian Character

Document Code: AMES-003-P1

Version: 1.0

Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Academic Session: 2026/2027

Progression: Crèche -> Nursery -> Reception -> Basic 1

Motto: In God We Trust

PART I OFFICIAL STATEMENT

Part I establishes the educational foundation upon which the complete AMES Early Years Curriculum is built. It should be read together with the approved detailed curricula for Crèche, Nursery and Reception and the AMES curriculum implementation framework.

It establishes the purpose and philosophy, identity, curriculum architecture, developmental progression, relationship between the EYFS for England, AMES requirements, Montessori-informed practice and Nigerian contextualisation, principles governing teaching and learning, and assessment principles through which teaching responds to children's development.

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

CHAPTER 1 - PURPOSE AND PHILOSOPHY OF THE AMES EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM

Document Code: AMES-003-P1-C1 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

1.1 Curriculum Purpose

The AMES Early Years Curriculum provides every child with a coherent, ambitious and developmentally appropriate educational journey from **Crèche through Nursery and Reception**. It develops communication, language, relationships, physical development, literacy, mathematics, understanding of the world, creativity, independence, character, curiosity, confidence and responsibility.

AMES asks what children understand, communicate, do independently, know, apply and whether they are becoming ready for the next stage. High expectations remain developmentally appropriate. **AMBITION DOES NOT REQUIRE PREMATURE FORMALISATION.**

1.2 The AMES Curriculum Identity

A. EYFS for England: the principal educational reference for the school's British-system Early Years programme. Because Angel Montessori School operates in Nigeria, English statutory requirements are not automatically Nigerian legal requirements; where adopted, they become AMES educational requirements.

B. Montessori-Informed Practice: selected principles strengthen independence, concentration, order, coordination, Practical Life, purposeful activity, care of resources, self-management and responsibility.

C. Nigerian Context: curriculum includes family, school, community, Owo, Ondo State, Nigeria, Africa and the wider world through authentic stories, music, foods, plants, animals, occupations, markets, transport, celebrations, art, landscapes, language and community experiences.

D. Christian Character: love, kindness, respect, honesty, responsibility, patience, gratitude, forgiveness, compassion, perseverance, service, stewardship, wisdom and courage are **TAUGHT -> MODELLED -> PRACTISED -> NOTICED -> REFLECTED UPON.**

1.3 The AMES Identity Statement

BRITISH IN FRAMEWORK

MONTESSORI-INFORMED IN PRACTICE

NIGERIAN IN CONTEXT

CHRISTIAN IN CHARACTER

The four dimensions complement one another but are not confused: EYFS provides the principal framework; AMES determines internal standards; Montessori strengthens selected pedagogy; Nigeria provides authentic context; Christian character shapes values.

1.4 Curriculum Versus Topic

Topics such as My Family, Animals, Transport or Water provide contexts but do not define learning. Teachers must identify the learning beneath activities. **THEME PROVIDES CONTEXT - LEARNING PROVIDES PURPOSE.**

1.5 Curriculum Progression Principle

Broad progression: **EXPERIENCE -> NOTICE -> NAME -> UNDERSTAND -> PRACTISE -> APPLY -> EXPLAIN.** Crèche: **EXPERIENCE -> RESPOND -> EXPLORE -> NAME.** Nursery: **EXPLORE -> NAME -> DESCRIBE -> PRACTISE.** Reception: **UNDERSTAND -> PRACTISE -> APPLY -> EXPLAIN.** Basic 1 transition: **SECURE -> APPLY -> EXPLAIN -> REASON.**

1.6 Revisit, Deepen and Apply

Important concepts return through **REVISIT -> DEEPEN -> APPLY.** Repetition without development is not progression. The context may return while thinking becomes more sophisticated.

1.7 Curriculum Entitlement

Every child is entitled to breadth: all seven areas, books, conversation, music, rhymes, movement, mathematics, literacy, investigation, creativity, Practical Life, purposeful play, continuous provision, outdoors, relationships, cultural knowledge and increasing independence. **BREADTH IS PART OF QUALITY.**

CHAPTER 2 - CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE

Document Code: AMES-003-P1-C2 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

2.1 The Seven Areas of Learning

Prime: Communication and Language; Personal, Social and Emotional Development; Physical Development. Specific: Literacy; Mathematics; Understanding the World; Expressive Arts and Design. **NO AREA SHOULD BECOME INVISIBLE BECAUSE ANOTHER IS EASIER TO TIMETABLE OR ASSESS.**

2.2 AMES Curriculum Dimensions

The seven areas are strengthened through Montessori-informed practice, Practical Life, Christian character, Nigerian/African knowledge, books/storytelling, outdoor learning, continuous provision, music/rhyme, purposeful technology where appropriate, parent partnership and inclusion.

2.3 Curriculum Organisation

Annual Curriculum -> Termly Curriculum -> Curriculum Sequence -> Weekly Curriculum -> Daily Responsive Teaching. The model is **CENTRALLY CONTROLLED CURRICULUM + PROFESSIONALLY RESPONSIVE TEACHING.**

2.4 Calendar Principle

AMES does not force every term into an identical number of teaching weeks. Curriculum implementation follows the approved academic calendar and distinguishes teaching weeks from revision, assessment, holidays, special events, transition activities and other authorised programmes.

2.5 Curriculum Areas Are Connected

Integrated experiences are encouraged, but **INTEGRATION MUST NOT MAKE CURRICULUM KNOWLEDGE INVISIBLE.**

2.6 Knowledge, Skills and Understanding

AMES develops Knowledge, Skills, Language, Thinking and Independence together.

2.7 Curriculum Progression Across the Year

First Term establishes security, belonging, routines, relationships, communication, baseline understanding and foundations. Second Term deepens knowledge, language, investigation, reasoning and application. Third Term consolidates, connects, applies and extends while preparing transition. Detailed approved termly documents remain authoritative.

2.8 Curriculum Documentation Hierarchy

PART I - CURRICULUM FOUNDATIONS

PART II - CRÈCHE CURRICULUM

PART III - NURSERY CURRICULUM

PART IV - RECEPTION CURRICULUM

PART V - CURRICULUM IMPLEMENTATION & PEDAGOGY

This replaces the provisional structure used in the original Volume III draft; the detailed approved curriculum documents take precedence over abbreviated earlier summaries.

CHAPTER 3 - DEVELOPMENTAL PROGRESSION: CRÈCHE -> NURSERY -> RECEPTION

Document Code: AMES-003-P1-C3 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

3.1 Development Is a Journey

Every stage builds on what came before. **KNOW WHERE THE CHILD HAS BEEN -> KNOW WHERE THE CHILD IS -> KNOW WHERE THE CHILD IS GOING.**

3.2 Crèche

Foundations: secure relationships, communication, sensory exploration, movement, routine, books, songs, rhymes, self-care, cause/effect, vocabulary, Practical Life and emerging independence. Learning occurs through relationships, repetition, sensory experience, movement, imitation, exploration and responsive interaction. Formal academic pressure is inappropriate.

3.3 Nursery

Builds conversation, vocabulary, story comprehension, phonological awareness, number sense, comparison, pattern, physical coordination, social understanding, curiosity, investigation, creativity, world knowledge, Practical Life, concentration and independence. **NURSERY IS NOT AN EASIER RECEPTION CLASS.**

3.4 Reception

Systematically strengthens spoken language, systematic synthetic phonics, decodable reading, comprehension, literature, meaningful writing, number sense, mathematical reasoning, world knowledge, enquiry, creativity, physical competence, self-regulation, Practical Life, responsibility and independence. **RECEPTION REMAINS EARLY YEARS.**

3.5 Literacy Progression

LISTEN -> SPEAK -> UNDERSTAND -> ENJOY LANGUAGE -> HEAR SOUNDS -> DECODE -> READ -> COMPOSE -> WRITE. Crèche: books, songs, rhymes, conversation, environmental language, mark-making. Nursery: books, storytelling, rhyme, sound awareness, phonological awareness, oral blending foundations, meaningful marks. Reception: systematic synthetic phonics, decodable reading, comprehension, rich literature, composition and meaningful writing. Formal SSP begins in Reception according to the adopted programme.

3.6 Mathematical Progression

EXPERIENCE -> MANIPULATE -> NOTICE -> TALK -> REPRESENT -> REASON -> APPLY. Develop matching, sorting, subitising, counting, cardinality, comparison, composition, relationships, pattern, shape, space, measure, vocabulary and reasoning; prioritise depth before superficial acceleration.

3.7 Communication Progression

Crèche: HEAR -> RESPOND -> NAME. Nursery: NAME -> DESCRIBE -> CONVERSE. Reception: DESCRIBE -> EXPLAIN -> REASON.

3.8 Practical Life and Independence Progression

Crèche: **DO WITH ME -> LET ME HELP -> LET ME TRY.** Nursery: **I CAN DO MORE -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY -> I AM BECOMING INDEPENDENT.** Reception: **I CAN MANAGE MYSELF AND MY LEARNING -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY FOR MY LEARNING ENVIRONMENT -> I AM READY TO TAKE GREATER RESPONSIBILITY.**

3.9 Knowledge of the World

SELF -> FAMILY -> SCHOOL -> COMMUNITY -> OWO -> ONDO STATE -> NIGERIA -> AFRICA -> WORLD. This represents an expanding understanding, not a rigid geography timetable.

3.10 Progression Into Basic 1

By the end of Reception children increasingly communicate, discuss, follow instructions, apply phonics, read matched decodables, enjoy/discuss literature, write meaningfully, use mathematical knowledge flexibly, explain simple reasoning, manage resources/self-care, work independently, cooperate, question, persist and organise themselves. **PREPARE THE CHILD FOR BASIC 1 - DO NOT TURN RECEPTION INTO BASIC 1.**

CHAPTER 4 - THE AMES TEACHING AND LEARNING MODEL

Document Code: AMES-003-P1-C4 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

4.1 Purpose

Curriculum defines what children should learn; pedagogy determines how adults help them learn. **CHILD ↔ ADULT ↔ ENVIRONMENT ↔ CURRICULUM** work together. Part V provides the full operational model.

4.2 Five Modes of Learning

Direct Teaching; Guided Learning; Purposeful Play; Independent Practice; Responsive Interaction. No single mode dominates the whole curriculum.

4.3 Intentional Teaching

Direct teaching is appropriate for new knowledge, phonics, mathematical modelling, vocabulary, story instruction, Practical Life demonstrations, physical skills, safety, shared reading/writing and investigation techniques.

4.4 Purposeful Play

High-quality play develops communication, imagination, planning, mathematics, literacy, problem-solving, cooperation, experimentation, persistence and self-regulation. **PLAY WITH PURPOSE - NOT PLAY FOR APPEARANCE.**

4.5 Continuous Provision

Provide books, communication/storytelling, mark-making/writing, mathematics, construction, small world, role play, creative materials, investigation, Practical Life, fine motor/sensory and outdoor learning; Reception may increasingly include purposeful technology. Themes enhance rather than unnecessarily replace provision.

4.6 The Prepared Environment

Environment promotes independence, choice, concentration, communication, exploration, order, responsibility and creativity. Resources are safe, accessible, organised, purposeful, complete, inclusive and developmentally appropriate.

4.7 The Role of the Adult

Practitioner roles include observer, communicator, teacher, model, questioner, storyteller, facilitator, assessor, protector and designer. Long-term objective: **INCREASINGLY CAPABLE AND INDEPENDENT CHILDREN.**

4.8 Scaffolding

SUPPORT -> PRACTISE -> WITHDRAW -> INDEPENDENCE. Before intervening ask: Can the child attempt this safely?

4.9 Communication-Rich Teaching

Every practitioner is a language teacher, modelling rich vocabulary, complete sentences, conversation, storytelling, reasoning, songs, rhymes and expressive reading.

4.10 Outdoor Learning

Outdoor learning is curriculum, developing physical competence, language, mathematics, science, creativity, problem-solving, risk awareness, social development, environmental knowledge and wellbeing.

4.11 Worksheets

Worksheets may occasionally have a valid purpose, but **THE NUMBER OF COMPLETED PAGES IS NOT A MEASURE OF CURRICULUM QUALITY.**

4.12 Inclusion Within Teaching

Ask **WHAT WILL HELP THIS CHILD ACCESS THIS LEARNING?** Use appropriate adjustments while maintaining high expectations.

4.13 The AMES Classroom

An effective classroom feels **CALM • PURPOSEFUL • WARM • ACTIVE • ORDERED • CURIOUS • CHILD-CENTRED.**

CHAPTER 5 - ASSESSMENT, BASELINE AND CURRICULUM RESPONSE

Document Code: AMES-003-P1-C5 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

5.1 Purpose of Assessment

Assessment improves teaching and learning by identifying what children know/can do, what is emerging, misconceptions, barriers, support needs and next steps.

5.2 The AMES Teaching and Assessment Cycle

Official overarching cycle: **KNOW -> PLAN -> TEACH -> OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND -> REVIEW**. KNOW curriculum/child/prior learning; PLAN next learning; TEACH appropriately; OBSERVE; INTERPRET evidence; RESPOND; REVIEW impact.

5.3 Focused Observation Cycle

Shorter observation process: **OBSERVE -> UNDERSTAND -> PLAN -> RESPOND**, sitting inside the broader cycle.

5.4 Beginning-of-Year Baseline

Baseline considers communication, relationships, PSED, physical development, literacy foundations, mathematics, independence, self-care, attention, interests and possible support needs. Crèche is predominantly observational/relationship-based; Nursery play/conversation/interaction-based; Reception may add carefully selected direct checks. Assessment should not turn first weeks into examinations.

5.5 Formative Assessment

Occurs continuously through interaction, questioning, observation, reading, writing, mathematics, play, Practical Life, investigation, creative work and independent application.

5.6 Evidence

Evidence includes what children say/do, reading, writing, mathematical reasoning, independent application, practical activity, construction, creative work, adult interaction, focused observation and relevant parent information. **THE CHILD'S LEARNING IS THE EVIDENCE - NOT THE SIZE OF THE FILE.**

5.7 Progress Language

AMES internal descriptors: **Emerging** - beginning/significant support; **Developing** - increasingly evident but inconsistent/supported; **Secure** - independent and appropriate across suitable contexts. These are internal monitoring language, not statutory English EYFS Profile judgement terminology.

5.8 Reception End-of-Year Reference

AMES uses the Early Learning Goals as part of its British-system end-of-Reception reference framework. ELGs are statutory end-of-Reception expectations within England's EYFS system; they are not Nigerian statutory requirements. AMES adopts them as an important reference alongside school curriculum evidence, transition information and educational expectations.

5.9 Assessment and Intervention

NOTICE -> CHECK -> ADAPT -> SUPPORT -> REVIEW -> ESCALATE WHERE NECESSARY. Consider attendance, language exposure, instruction, hearing/vision, development, environment, SEND, wellbeing and relevant family circumstances. Teachers do not diagnose outside competence.

5.10 Greater Challenge

Secure learners are not automatically rushed into later content. Deepen through questions, new contexts, reasoning, explanation, problem-solving, richer vocabulary, independence and sophisticated application. **DEEPEN BEFORE YOU ACCELERATE.**

5.11 Assessment Workload

Avoid photographs of everything, repeated secure evidence, lengthy copied descriptions, duplicate assessments and display-only evidence. **ASSESSMENT SHOULD SERVE TEACHING - TEACHING SHOULD NOT SERVE THE ASSESSMENT FILE.**

PART I IMPLEMENTATION PRINCIPLES

Principle 1

THEME PROVIDES CONTEXT - LEARNING PROVIDES PURPOSE.

Principle 2

REVISIT -> DEEPEN -> APPLY.

Principle 3

UNDERSTANDING BEFORE ACCELERATION.

Principle 4

PLAY WITH PURPOSE.

Principle 5

OUTDOOR LEARNING IS CURRICULUM.

Principle 6

ONE SYSTEMATIC PHONICS SYSTEM - ONE CONSISTENT LANGUAGE.

Principle 7

ACCESS BEFORE ASSUMPTION.

Principle 8

SUPPORT -> PRACTISE -> WITHDRAW -> INDEPENDENCE.

Principle 9

PREPARE THE CHILD FOR BASIC 1 - DO NOT TURN RECEPTION INTO BASIC 1.

Principle 10

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

VOLUME III DOCUMENT ARCHITECTURE

Part	Title	Function
I	Curriculum Foundations	Philosophy, architecture, progression, pedagogy and assessment foundation
II	Crèche Curriculum	Complete termly Crèche curriculum and progression
III	Nursery Curriculum	Complete termly Nursery curriculum and progression
IV	Reception Curriculum	Complete termly Reception curriculum and transition
V	Curriculum Implementation & Pedagogy	Planning, assessment, provision, literacy, mathematics, inclusion, QA and implementation tools

The detailed curriculum contained in Parts II-IV takes precedence over the shorter curriculum examples contained in the original developmental Volume III draft.

PART I DECLARATION

We believe Early Years curriculum should be ambitious and developmentally appropriate; children learn through relationships, language, books, purposeful play, intentional teaching, movement and doing. They need knowledge, vocabulary, mathematics, stories, creativity, independence and character. Nigerian children should know their community, Nigeria and Africa while becoming curious about the wider world.

Reception should teach reading systematically, develop meaningful writing and prepare children for Basic 1 without becoming Basic 1. Mathematics should develop understanding before superficial acceleration. Montessori-informed practice should develop capable children. Assessment should improve teaching; support should begin early; greater challenge should deepen thinking; and teachers require a curriculum they can actually use.

WHAT ARE CHILDREN LEARNING?
WHY ARE THEY LEARNING IT?
WHAT CAME BEFORE?
WHAT COMES NEXT?
CAN THEY USE WHAT THEY HAVE LEARNED?
ARE THEY BECOMING MORE INDEPENDENT?
ARE THEY BECOMING MORE CAPABLE?

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Series: Angel Montessori Education System (AMES)

Volume: III - The Complete Early Years Curriculum

Part: I - Curriculum Foundations

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Chapter Codes: AMES-003-P1-C1 to AMES-003-P1-C5

Version: 1.0

Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Coverage: Crèche • Nursery • Reception

Progression: Crèche -> Nursery -> Reception -> Basic 1

Academic Session: 2026/2027

ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM & SCHEME OF LEARNING

PART II - CRECHE CURRICULUM FIRST TERM

Official Approved Curriculum Record
Version 1.0

Document Code: AMES-003-C-T1
Class: Crèche
Academic Session: 2026/2027
Status: APPROVED & LOCKED
Framework: EYFS for England + AMES Volume II
Motto: In God We Trust

First Term Curriculum Intent

During First Term, the AMES Crèche child should increasingly develop **SECURITY -> RELATIONSHIP -> COMMUNICATION -> MOVEMENT -> EXPLORATION -> ROUTINE -> INDEPENDENCE**. The three prime EYFS areas receive particular priority while meaningful experiences are provided across Literacy, Mathematics, Understanding the World and Expressive Arts and Design.

Teaching rule: Crèche assessment is observational. There is no formal examination week. Teachers observe children through play, conversation, movement, books, songs, mealtimes, self-care, Practical Life, outdoor exploration and relationships.

First-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	I Belong Here	Security, settling and relationships
2	This Is Me	Identity, name and self-awareness
3	My Amazing Body	Body awareness and movement
4	I Can Take Care of Myself	Hygiene and emerging independence
5	My Family	Familiar people and belonging
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive review / mid-term
7	My Home and My School	Familiar environments and routines
8	I Explore With My Senses	Sensory discrimination and language
9	Plants Around Me	Nature, growth and care
10	Animals Around Me	Animals, sounds and movement
11	Shape, Colour, Pattern and Making	Early mathematics and creativity
12	Giving, Gratitude and Christmas	Christian character and celebration
13	I Have Grown	Reflection, transition and term closure

Week 1 - I Belong Here

Children begin to experience school as a safe, predictable and caring place. Adults use children's names and simple routine language; support separation sensitively; establish arrival, meal, rest and collection routines; provide free movement, carrying, pushing, stacking and ball play; share picture books and repetitive rhymes; introduce one/more, big/small, in/out and up/down through real experience; explore the classroom and outdoors; provide welcome songs, mark-making and simple Practical Life.

Character: Love and Belonging. **Vocabulary:** hello, bye, teacher, friend, school, book, cup, bag, sit, come, more, finished.

Observe: comfort seeking, response to voice, exploration, communication of needs, movement and recognition of routines.

Week 2 - This Is Me

Children increasingly recognise themselves as individuals with a name, face, belongings and preferences. Use names frequently, mirrors, photographs and personal belongings; encourage simple choices; use name songs and personalised picture books; match familiar objects and explore one/two meaningfully. **Practical Life:** locate bag/cup and place belongings with support. **Character:** I am valued and others are valued. **Vocabulary:** me, my, name, face, hair, eyes, smile, boy, girl, happy.

Week 3 - My Amazing Body

Children notice major body parts and discover what their bodies can do. Teach head, hand, foot, eye, ear, nose, mouth and tummy through action songs, movement, books and play. Explore walking, running where appropriate, reaching, stretching, clapping, stamping, bending, dancing and ball rolling. Introduce simple functions such as eyes-see, ears-hear, hands-hold. **Practical Life:** dressing participation. **Character:** Gratitude.

Week 4 - I Can Take Care of Myself

Children participate increasingly in simple self-care. Use vocabulary wash, soap, water, clean, dirty, towel, wipe, eat and drink. Practise handwashing, cup/spoon use, wiping hands and assisted dressing. Explore full/empty and more/less through water play. Central progression: **WATCH -> HELP -> TRY -> REPEAT**. Toileting and intimate care remain private, dignified and professionally managed. **Character:** Responsibility.

Week 5 - My Family

Children strengthen security and language by connecting school learning with familiar relationships. Use family photographs and vocabulary mummy, daddy, parent, brother, sister, baby, grandma, grandpa, family and home, while respecting varied family structures. Share family books and songs; use dolls and home role play; explore small-group quantities informally. **Practical Life:** care for dolls. **Character:** Love and Care.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Mid-Term Flexibility

This is not an examination week. Revisit settling, language, body awareness, self-care, relationships, movement, books, songs and independence. Teachers review what each child trusts, communicates and attempts independently, what remains difficult and what should happen next.

Week 7 - My Home and My School

Children recognise features and routines of familiar places. Teach home, school, room, door, chair, table, bed, outside, inside and toilet. Explore inside/outside, on/under, in/out and near/far through movement. Use role play and block building. **Practical Life:** carry, place, sort and restore. Use photographs of real local homes, the school and familiar Owo surroundings.

Week 8 - I Explore With My Senses

Children investigate through seeing, hearing, touching, smelling and safe tasting. Teach see, hear, touch, smell, taste, soft, rough, loud, quiet, sweet, cold and warm. Provide texture exploration, sound response, sensory materials, sorting, sound makers, collage, colour and music. Montessori-informed experiences include matching textures, sound discrimination, object sorting and simple colour matching.

Week 9 - Plants Around Me

Children encounter plants as living parts of their environment. Teach plant, leaf, flower, tree, grass, soil, water and grow. Explore school grounds, touch leaves, observe flowers, water plants and notice size, colour and texture. Use nature books, leaf printing and collage. **Practical Life:** plant care. **Character:** Stewardship.

Week 10 - Animals Around Me

Children notice familiar animals, sounds, movements and features. Prioritise recognisable local animals such as dog, cat, goat, chicken, bird, fish and cow. Use movement imitation, matching, picture books and rhymes. Introduce basic observations about

sound, movement, body covering and where animals live. **Character:** Gentleness and care.

Week 11 - Shape, Colour, Pattern and Making

Children explore early mathematical relationships through real objects, movement and construction: match, sort, fit, stack, big/small, round, same/different and repeated experiences. Use blocks, posting, puzzles, large mark-making, paint, printing, tearing, sticking, music and movement. Montessori-informed work includes simple matching, sorting, obvious size grading, posting and stacking. Adults protect purposeful repetition and concentration.

Week 12 - Giving, Gratitude and Christmas

Children experience Christmas within the school's Christian identity through story, music, relationships, gratitude and giving rather than academic worksheets. Teach Christmas, Jesus, baby, gift, give, thank you, love, joy and family. Share an age-appropriate Nativity story, songs, movement and child-led festive art. **Character:** Love, Joy, Gratitude and Giving.

Week 13 - I Have Grown

Celebrate development without an academic performance contest. Revisit school, self, body, family, care, senses, plants, animals, colour, shape, songs, stories and routines. Review the child across the seven EYFS areas plus Practical Life/independence using professional observation, conversation, selected creations, purposeful authorised photographs, parent information and significant learning records.

Daily Non-Negotiable Curriculum

The weekly focus never replaces the everyday Crèche curriculum. Every day should include appropriate opportunities for warm relationships, conversation, free movement, outdoor experience, books, songs and rhymes, purposeful play, sensory exploration, Practical Life, self-care, rest, meals, choice, child-initiated exploration and adult-guided interaction.

Crèche Literacy Entitlement

There is no formal SSP programme in Crèche. First Term literacy provides daily stories, songs, nursery rhymes, sound play, conversation, picture books, page turning, environmental sounds, meaningful name recognition, drawing, scribbling, large-scale mark-making, finger play and physical preparation.

Crèche Mathematics Entitlement

Mathematics is experienced through matching, sorting, filling, emptying, stacking, posting, one/more, big/small, full/empty, in/out, up/down, simple quantity, shape, space, movement, pattern, songs and everyday routines.

First-Term Practical Life Progression

ADULT DOES WITH CHILD -> CHILD HELPS ADULT -> CHILD ATTEMPTS WITH SUPPORT -> CHILD DOES FAMILIAR PARTS INDEPENDENTLY.

Priority experiences include carrying, placing, pouring, feeding, wiping, washing hands, putting away, opening/closing, simple dressing participation, plant care and resource restoration.

First-Term Language Strategy

Adults expand children's language naturally. If a child says 'Dog', the adult may respond, 'Yes, a brown dog. The dog is running.' If a child says 'Water', the adult may respond, 'You want more water.' Adults model richer language without pressuring children to repeat.

Inclusion

Children may communicate nonverbally, use home language, require sensory or physical adaptations, take longer to settle or show advanced skills. Teachers adapt access without removing curriculum entitlement.

Parent Partnership

Home connections should remain simple and developmentally appropriate: talk together, name everyday objects, read picture books, sing, count naturally, encourage self-feeding and dressing, sort safe household items, water a plant, notice animals, draw and participate in simple household routines.

End-of-Term Curriculum Expectation

Depending on age, starting point and individual development, teachers hope to see increasing evidence that the child feels secure with familiar school adults; recognises routines; responds to familiar language; communicates needs increasingly; enjoys books, songs and rhymes; explores confidently; moves with increasing control; uses hands purposefully; participates in self-care; notices body parts and familiar relationships; explores through the senses; notices plants and animals; experiences early mathematical relationships; creates and makes; begins to restore familiar resources; participates alongside other children; and develops greater independence. These are curriculum expectations, not pass/fail examination criteria.

Crèche First-Term Declaration

We will help children feel safe. We will know them. We will speak with them. We will listen. We will sing. We will read. We will move. We will explore. We will play. We will go outdoors. We will help children care for themselves and their environment. We will protect childhood from premature formalisation. We will observe without turning children into data. We will work with families. We will respect individual development. We will create increasing independence.

**EYFS-ALIGNED IN FOUNDATION
MONTESSORI-INFORMED IN PRACTICE
NIGERIAN IN CONTEXT
CHRISTIAN IN CHARACTER**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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Second-Term Curriculum Intent

First Term established **SECURITY -> RELATIONSHIP -> COMMUNICATION -> MOVEMENT -> EXPLORATION -> ROUTINE -> INDEPENDENCE**. Second Term deliberately progresses towards **SECURITY -> PARTICIPATION -> COMMUNICATION -> CURIOSITY -> CHOICE -> INCREASING INDEPENDENCE**. The child moves from simply experiencing the environment towards participating purposefully within it.

Progression From First Term

First Term	Second Term Progression
Respond to familiar words	Understand and use more words
Explore alongside others	Participate increasingly with others
Follow familiar routines	Anticipate and contribute to routines
Carry with support	Carry and restore more independently
Explore sensory materials	Notice and compare properties
Experience quantity	Notice simple quantity differences
Recognise familiar places	Notice features of the wider community
Participate in self-care	Attempt familiar self-care
Listen to stories	Anticipate and respond to familiar stories
Explore materials	Make choices about materials
Notice nature	Participate in caring for the environment

Second-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	Weather and My Day	Weather awareness and daily routines
2	Sun, Rain and What We Wear	Environment, clothing and self-care
3	People Who Help Me	Familiar community relationships
4	Helpers at Work	Occupations, tools and role play
5	Things That Move	Transport, movement and sound
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Review and responsive curriculum
7	Journeys and Places	Position, movement and familiar journeys
8	Food I Know	Food vocabulary, senses and healthy experiences
9	Farms and Markets	Food origins and Nigerian community life
10	Building and Making	Materials, construction and problem-solving
11	Nigeria - My Home	Identity, culture, music and environment
12	Music, Art and Celebration	Creative expression and cultural experience
13	Look What I Can Do	Reflection, independence and term closure

Week 1 - Weather and My Day

Children notice simple changes in weather and connect them with everyday experiences. Vocabulary: sun, rain, hot, wet, dry, sky, outside, today. Adults model meaningful sentences, maintain predictable routines, use weather books and songs, and explore wet/dry, full/empty, more/less and simple first/then sequences. Children look outside daily and notice sunshine, rain, clouds and wind. Practical Life includes wiping safe spills and carrying belongings. Character: Gratitude. Use weather actually experienced in Owo.

Week 2 - Sun, Rain and What We Wear

Children connect weather with simple everyday choices. Vocabulary: shirt, shoes, hat, clothes, wear, wet, dry, hot, rain. Encourage dressing participation, pulling, pushing, lifting arms and attempting shoes. Match pairs such as shoes/socks and sort by visible property. Explore simple reasons for umbrellas, light clothing and footwear. Practical Life: WATCH -> HELP -> TRY. Character: Responsibility.

Week 3 - People Who Help Me

Children recognise familiar people who help at home, school and in the community. Vocabulary: teacher, parent, doctor, nurse, driver, cleaner, helper, help, care. Teach trusted/familiar adults rather than implying all adults are safe. Use books, actual school photographs where appropriate, role play and simple person/object matching. Character: Service.

Week 4 - Helpers at Work

Children notice that people use different objects and tools to perform jobs. Vocabulary: work, tool, broom, book, car, bag, clean, fix, drive, teach. Provide safe real objects, sweeping, carrying, transferring, matching and sorting. Include familiar Owo occupations such as teachers, traders, farmers, healthcare workers, drivers and craftspeople. Character: Service and Respect.

Week 5 - Things That Move

Children investigate familiar transport through movement, sound and play. Vocabulary: car, bus, bike, motorcycle, truck, wheel, move, stop, go, fast, slow. Use push/pull toys, wheels, stop/go games, vehicle books, sounds, printing and box construction. Introduce simple road-awareness language: stop, hold hands, wait, adult.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Revisit weather, clothing, helpers, tools, transport, movement, vocabulary, Practical Life, books, songs and routines. Review whether vocabulary, participation, routine anticipation and independent attempts have increased and plan responsively.

Week 7 - Journeys and Places

Children connect movement with familiar destinations. Vocabulary: go, come, home, school, road, market, car, bus, near, far, here, there. Explore in/out, on/off, near/far, forward/back and under/over physically. Use familiar local photographs, journey stories, tracks and travel-bag Practical Life. Character: Patience.

Week 8 - Food I Know

Children explore familiar foods through language, senses, classification and Practical Life. Vocabulary includes food, eat, drink, fruit, water, rice, yam, bread, banana, orange, sweet, soft, hard. Mealtimes support choice, communication and independence. Explore one/more, full/empty, big/small and sorting. Practical Life: wash suitable fruit, transfer, serve and wipe. Character: Gratitude.

Week 9 - Farms and Markets

Children begin connecting familiar foods with places and people involved in producing and selling them. Vocabulary: farm, farmer, market, food, fruit, vegetable, chicken, goat, buy, basket. Use local market scenes and produce. Introduce farmer grows -> market sells -> family buys -> we eat through experience, without requiring verbal reproduction. Use basket sorting, market role play and transfer work. Character: Thankfulness and Respect for Work.

Week 10 - Building and Making

Children investigate joining, stacking, filling, fitting, knocking down and rebuilding. Vocabulary: build, block, tall, fall, up, down, on, inside, more, again. Explore size, position, fit, space and simple comparison through blocks, boxes, loose parts, dough and collage. Adults allow attempt, collapse, retry, repetition and problem-solving. Character: Perseverance.

Week 11 - Nigeria: My Home

Children develop positive cultural belonging through familiar experiences rather than geography memorisation. Vocabulary: Nigeria, home, family, music, food, clothes, flag. Experience Nigerian music, foods, clothing, stories, people, landscapes and everyday life, including Owo and Ondo State. Explore fabric patterns, colour matching, music and movement. Character: Respect.

Week 12 - Music, Art and Celebration

Children communicate and create through sound, movement, colour and materials. Vocabulary: sing, dance, drum, loud, quiet, fast, slow, colour, make. Explore dance, clapping, stamping, repeated beats, drumming, call-and-response, painting, collage and construction. Include appropriate Yoruba and Nigerian songs alongside wider children's repertoire. Character: Joy and Community.

Week 13 - Look What I Can Do

The final week makes development visible through participation rather than testing. Revisit favourite stories, songs, materials, Practical Life, movement, construction, nature, role play and outdoor experiences. Review Communication & Language, PSSED, Physical Development, Literacy, Mathematics, Understanding the World, Expressive Arts and Practical Life/independence.

Second-Term Language Progression

Adults increasingly model expanded sentences such as 'The car is moving', 'The big bus', 'Your shirt is wet', 'The rain is falling' and 'You put three blocks on'. Children are not required to repeat adult sentences; adults provide rich language worth growing into.

Second-Term Mathematics Spine

Children encounter matching, sorting, one/more, quantity, big/small, full/empty, in/out, on/off, up/down, near/far, fast/slow, shape, space, pattern, size, fitting, stacking and simple sequencing. The progression is **EXPERIENCE -> NOTICE -> COMPARE**, not worksheet -> memorisation -> test.

Second-Term Literacy Entitlement

Daily literacy continues through high-quality picture books, songs, rhymes, conversation, sound discrimination, environmental sounds, repeated refrains, story anticipation, picture discussion, meaningful name exposure, scribbling, drawing, large mark-making and fine-motor development. There remains no formal SSP programme for Crèche.

Continuous Provision

Provide ongoing access to books, construction, small world, home/role play, mathematics, creative materials, Practical Life, sensory experiences and outdoor provision. Enhanced provision changes according to curriculum intent.

Practical Life Progression

Second Term expects more participation than First Term: **CHILD PARTICIPATES AND ATTEMPTS**. Experiences include carrying a cup, using a spoon, wiping a small spill, placing a bag, restoring toys, carrying a basket, watering plants, transferring objects, attempting clothing, helping prepare food and sweeping with child-sized equipment. The aim is increasing capability, not perfect performance.

Christian Character Spine

Second Term deliberately develops Gratitude, Responsibility, Service, Respect, Patience, Thankfulness, Perseverance, Respect for Identity, and Joy/Community. Values should be modelled and practised rather than merely recited.

Nigerian and Local Knowledge

Children increasingly encounter Owo, school surroundings, local weather, roads, vehicles, community workers, markets, farm produce, foods, music, clothing, stories, families and Nigerian cultural experiences. **START WITH THE CHILD'S REAL WORLD - THEN GRADUALLY WIDEN IT.**

Inclusion and SEND

Adapt materials, position, time, adult support, sensory load, language and method of response according to communication access, home language, sensory needs, physical access, emotional regulation, attention, hearing/vision concerns, feeding needs, developmental variation and strengths. Do not remove meaningful curriculum participation unnecessarily.

Parent Partnership

Home connections may include talking about weather, allowing the child to help choose clothing, naming trusted helpers, noticing vehicles, talking during journeys, naming foods, visiting familiar markets safely, safe household sorting, building with boxes, listening to Nigerian music, sharing family stories and encouraging self-care. **HOME LEARNING IS NOT CRÈCHE HOMEWORK.**

End-of-Second-Term Expectations

Depending on age, starting point and individual development, children should show increasing evidence of security with familiar adults; participation in routines; understanding of everyday language; growing expressive communication; interest in books and songs; physical confidence; hand control; self-care participation; simple matching and sorting; awareness of quantity and size; recognition of familiar people, occupations and transport; interest in food, nature and community; constructive and creative exploration; cultural belonging; participation alongside peers; resource restoration; and increasing independence. These are developmental curriculum expectations, not pass/fail criteria.

Progression Into Third Term

At the end of Second Term, the curriculum moves from **I AM SAFE** to **I PARTICIPATE** and increasingly towards **I CAN EXPLORE WITH PURPOSE**. Third Term can deepen growth and change, water, habitats, small creatures, cause and effect, simple technology, Africa and the wider world, problem-solving, communication and transition.

Crèche Second-Term Declaration

We will continue to protect security and relationships, but we will also expect growth. Children will increasingly participate, communicate, make choices, move with greater purpose, help, attempt, notice, compare, create and care. We will not mistake worksheets for curriculum, memorisation for understanding, or early formalisation for high expectations.

SECURE • COMMUNICATIVE • CURIOUS • CAPABLE • INDEPENDENT • READY TO KEEP LEARNING

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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Third-Term Curriculum Intent

Third Term completes the child's Crèche curriculum journey. First Term established **I AM SAFE -> I BELONG -> I EXPLORE**. Second Term developed **I PARTICIPATE -> I COMMUNICATE -> I MAKE CHOICES**. Third Term develops **I NOTICE -> I TRY -> I SOLVE -> I COMMUNICATE -> I DO MORE FOR MYSELF -> I AM READY TO MOVE FORWARD**. The purpose is not to turn Third Term Crèche into Nursery, but to deepen security, communication, curiosity, physical capability and independence.

Third-Term Progression

Earlier Crèche Experience	Third Term Progression
Explore objects	Explore with greater purpose
Respond to words	Understand and use increasing vocabulary
Watch adults	Participate and attempt
Notice differences	Begin comparing
Move freely	Move with increasing control
Explore materials	Select and use materials purposefully
Play beside children	Participate increasingly with others
Receive help	Attempt familiar routines
Notice nature	Observe simple change
Hear stories	Anticipate and participate
Experience problems	Try simple solutions
Depend heavily on adults	Seek appropriate help while attempting independently

Annual Crèche progression: EXPERIENCE -> PARTICIPATE -> NOTICE -> TRY -> CONNECT

Third-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	I Am Growing	Growth, change and identity
2	Plants Grow Too	Growth, care and observation
3	Wonderful Water	Sensory investigation and Practical Life
4	Water Around Us	Uses of water, care and safety
5	Little Creatures	Minibeasts, movement and observation
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive review
7	Homes for Living Things	Habitats, position and care
8	How Things Move and Work	Cause, effect and problem-solving
9	I Can Make Things Happen	Simple technology and purposeful action
10	Africa - Our Wider Home	Identity and widening world knowledge
11	Sounds, Stories and Creativity	Communication, imagination and expression
12	I Can Do More for Myself	Independence and Nursery preparation
13	Moving Forward	Reflection, celebration and transition

Week 1 - I Am Growing

Children notice that people grow and change. Vocabulary: baby, child, grow, big, small, tall, old, new, me. Use books, personal photographs where appropriate, movement and simple sequencing. Celebrate individual capability without comparing children. Practical Life asks, 'What can I do now?' through carrying, feeding, wiping, restoring and dressing attempts. Character: Gratitude.

Week 2 - Plants Grow Too

Revisit plants and deepen learning by noticing change over time: **REVISIT -> DEEPEN -> APPLY**. Vocabulary: seed, plant, grow, soil, water, leaf, flower, root. Plant a fast-growing seed where practical, observe regularly, water carefully and notice visible changes. Explore small/bigger, one/more, full/empty and seed-to-plant sequence. Character: Stewardship and Patience.

Week 3 - Wonderful Water

Investigate water through first-hand sensory and mathematical experiences. Vocabulary: water, wet, dry, pour, splash, full, empty, float, sink. Explore pouring, scooping, squeezing, transferring, capacity and safe float/sink experiences without requiring formal scientific explanations. Practical Life: pouring and wiping spills. Character: Care.

Week 4 - Water Around Us

Connect water with drinking, washing, cleaning, plant care, cooking through adult discussion and rain. Vocabulary: drink, wash, bath, rain, plant, clean, water, tap. Develop responsible habits and simple safety boundaries. Practical Life includes handwashing, plant watering and cleaning. Character: Stewardship - we do not waste water.

Week 5 - Little Creatures

Notice small living creatures safely and respectfully. Vocabulary may include ant, butterfly, bee, snail, insect, small, crawl, fly, wing, reflecting creatures children encounter. Observe movement, size, colour and location; use creature movement, matching, books, songs and creative representation. Adults check outdoor areas and avoid unsafe handling. Character: Gentleness.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

Responsive review rather than formal examination. Revisit growth, plants, water, small creatures, language, Practical Life, movement, books, mathematics and social participation. Review observation length, vocabulary, problem-solving attempts, independence, participation and routines, then strengthen needs before Nursery transition.

Week 7 - Homes for Living Things

Children notice that people and animals have places where they live. Vocabulary: home, nest, tree, water, ground, inside, outside, live. Use simple familiar associations without rigid inaccuracies. Explore inside/outside, on/under, high/low, matching, movement trails, stories and building homes with blocks, boxes and natural materials. Character: Care.

Week 8 - How Things Move and Work

Investigate simple cause and effect. Vocabulary: push, pull, turn, roll, open, close, stop, go, work. Explore wheels, doors, lids, ramps, safe cause-effect toys and switches. Adults ask 'What happened?' and model causal language. Use purposeful opening/closing, turning and fitting. Character: Perseverance.

Week 9 - I Can Make Things Happen

Children recognise that actions can produce predictable effects: press -> sound/light; push car -> movement; pour -> container fills; stack -> tower. Vocabulary: again, press, turn, make, happen, stop, start, open, close. Encourage persistence, simple first/then sequencing and help-seeking. Adults allow appropriate thinking time.

Week 10 - Africa: Our Wider Home

Widen the child's world from Nigeria towards Africa through positive encounter, not map memorisation. Progression: Me -> Family -> School -> Community -> Nigeria -> Africa. Experience varied African people, families, landscapes, homes, animals, music, art and environments without presenting Africa as one culture. Reinforce 'We live in Nigeria' and 'Nigeria is in Africa' without testing. Character: Respect and Love.

Week 11 - Sounds, Stories and Creativity

Children increasingly use sound, movement, marks and materials to communicate ideas. Vocabulary: story, sing, sound, drum, make, draw, dance, again. Use repeated stories, predictable refrains, rhymes, picture discussion, dance, rhythm, mark-making, drumming, singing, painting, dough, construction and pretend play. Include Yoruba/Nigerian songs and stories alongside wider literature. Character: Joy and Confidence.

Week 12 - I Can Do More for Myself

Consolidate independence for Nursery through capability rather than academic preparation. Children increasingly attempt to carry belongings, find personal items, use cup/spoon, wash hands, wipe spills, restore resources, carry trays/baskets, dress simply, follow routines, wait briefly, choose and ask for help. Core message: **HELP ME TO DO MORE FOR MYSELF**. Character: Responsibility and Independence.

Week 13 - Moving Forward

Celebrate the Crèche year and prepare emotionally for progression without formal graduation examination. Revisit favourite books, songs, movement, Practical Life, plants, water, animals, construction, creativity and routines. Where appropriate, visit the Nursery environment, meet adults, see familiar resources, share a story and return to the familiar Crèche base. Transition should be safe, gradual, positive and predictable. Character: Courage and Gratitude.

Third-Term Communication Progression

Adults continue expanding language naturally: 'You are pouring water into the cup'; 'A little ant is crawling'; 'The car is going down the ramp.' The objective is rich responsive interaction, not forced repetition.

Third-Term Mathematics Spine

Children encounter quantity, matching, sorting, comparison, big/small, more/less, full/empty, inside/outside, high/low, near/far, fast/slow, shape, space, pattern, capacity, simple sequencing and cause/effect. Progression: **EXPERIENCE -> NOTICE -> COMPARE -> ANTICIPATE.**

Third-Term Literacy Entitlement

Crèche literacy remains conversation, songs, rhymes, books, stories, sound play, environmental sounds, picture discussion, repeated refrains, meaningful names, drawing, scribbling, large-scale marks, fine-motor development and storytelling through play. There is no formal Reception SSP programme, spelling test, compulsory handwriting exercise or reading examination.

Third-Term Continuous Provision

Continue Books, Construction, Small World, Home/Role Play, Mathematics, Creative, Practical Life, Sensorial Experiences, Nature/Investigation and Outdoor Learning. Enhancements include plant/growth investigation, water exploration, minibeast observation, habitat small world, ramps, wheels, cause-effect resources, African stories/music and transition role play.

Practical Life - End-of-Crèche Progression

First Term: DO WITH ME -> Second Term: LET ME HELP -> Third Term: LET ME TRY -> Nursery: I CAN DO MORE. Children should enter Nursery not simply knowing more topics, but more capable.

Outdoor Curriculum

Provide plant observation, watering, weather, movement, large construction, water play, nature walks, small-creature observation, transport play, ramps, sound, shadow/light experiences and free physical exploration. Outdoor learning is curriculum, not merely break time.

Christian Character Spine

Third Term develops Gratitude, Patience, Stewardship, Gentleness, Care, Perseverance, Respect, Joy, Responsibility and Courage through everyday relationships and actions.

Nigerian and African Knowledge

By the end of Crèche, children should have meaningful encounters with identity, family, school, Owo/local community, Nigerian foods, markets, transport, weather, plants, animals, music, stories, clothing, Nigeria and introductory experiences of Africa. We build **belonging before abstraction.**

Inclusion and SEND

Transition must not be used to label children unfairly. Consider communication, home language, physical development, sensory processing, social interaction, emotional regulation, attention, hearing, vision, feeding, self-care, medical needs and strengths. Where concern exists: **OBSERVE -> DISCUSS -> SUPPORT -> REVIEW -> REFER APPROPRIATELY.** Parents remain partners.

Parent Partnership

Home connections may include baby photographs, plant watering, safe pouring, noticing rain and insects, building with boxes, pushing/rolling objects, Nigerian songs, African stories, handwashing, self-feeding, dressing participation, simple responsibilities and positive talk about Nursery. No Crèche homework packets are required.

Crèche to Nursery Transition Profile

Communication & Language: increasingly responds to familiar language, communicates needs, uses gestures/words/phrases according to development, attends to familiar stories and songs, and participates in interaction.

PSED: forms secure relationships, participates in routines, shows preferences, plays alongside/with others, tolerates short waits with support and seeks help appropriately.

Physical: moves confidently, manipulates objects, uses hands purposefully, participates in self-care and attempts simple dressing.

Literacy foundations: enjoys and handles books, attends to stories, joins rhymes, notices sounds and makes marks.

Mathematics foundations: meaningful experience of quantity, matching, sorting, size, position, pattern, shape, space, capacity and comparison.

Understanding the World: notices people, places, nature, weather, plants, animals, materials, simple cause/effect and familiar cultural experiences.

Expressive Arts: explores music, movement, drawing, paint, construction, pretend play and materials.

Practical Life: increasingly carries, places, restores, pours, wipes, feeds, washes, helps, chooses and attempts.

Transition question: IS THIS CHILD INCREASINGLY READY TO PARTICIPATE, COMMUNICATE, EXPLORE AND BECOME MORE INDEPENDENT IN NURSERY?

Complete Crèche Annual Progression

FIRST TERM - BELONG: I AM SAFE

Security, relationships, routines, body awareness, family, senses, nature, early independence.

SECOND TERM - PARTICIPATE: I TAKE PART

Communication, choice, community, transport, food, building, culture, greater Practical Life participation.

THIRD TERM - CONNECT: I EXPLORE WITH PURPOSE

Growth, change, investigation, cause/effect, problem-solving, wider-world awareness, greater independence and transition.

NURSERY: I AM READY TO EXPLORE, COMMUNICATE AND CONNECT MORE DEEPLY.

Annual journey: **BELONG -> PARTICIPATE -> CONNECT.**

End-of-Crèche Curriculum Entitlement

Every child leaving AMES Crèche should have experienced secure relationships, rich conversation, stories, books, songs, rhymes, movement, outdoor learning, sensory exploration, early mathematics, nature, construction, creative expression, Practical Life, self-care, family and community knowledge, Nigerian identity, introductory African awareness, Christian character, choice, problem-solving and increasing independence. No child's Crèche experience should be judged primarily by worksheets completed.

Teacher Year-End Review

Teachers should be able to explain what the child enjoys; how the child communicates; which relationships support the child; what the child can now do independently; what the child understands; how the child approaches new experiences; emerging mathematical ideas; engagement with books and language; movement and manipulation; support still required; and what the Nursery teacher should know. This informs transition without becoming a bureaucratic checklist.

Crèche Curriculum Quality Test

Did children feel secure? Were relationships warm? Was language rich? Were books available every day? Did children sing, move, go outdoors, investigate, encounter mathematics meaningfully, experience nature, create and develop Practical Life? Did adults allow attempts? Did independence increase? Was Nigerian identity visible? Was Christian character lived? Were different developmental needs respected? Did assessment improve teaching? Did parents contribute? Was childhood protected? **ARE OUR CHILDREN MORE CAPABLE THAN WHEN THEY ARRIVED?**

Crèche Third-Term & Year-End Declaration

We welcomed children into security. We helped them belong, communicate, explore, participate and care. We gave real responsibilities and allowed attempts, mistakes and retrying. We filled their days with language, books, songs, movement, nature, mathematics, creativity and investigation. We strengthened independence, introduced community, celebrated Nigeria, began widening their world towards Africa and lived Christian character through everyday relationships. We prepare them for Nursery because they are increasingly secure, communicative, curious, capable, independent and ready to keep learning.

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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Nursery First-Term Curriculum Intent

Nursery is a significant developmental progression from Crèche while remaining firmly within Early Years. Children increasingly **EXPLORE -> COMMUNICATE -> PARTICIPATE -> REPRESENT -> THINK -> CONNECT -> BECOME MORE INDEPENDENT**. The seven EYFS areas remain interconnected, with increasingly intentional adult-guided learning alongside sustained play, continuous provision, outdoor learning and child-initiated exploration.

Crèche to Nursery Developmental Shift

Crèche	Nursery Progression
Experience language	Use increasingly varied language
Communicate immediate needs	Participate in longer interaction
Listen to short stories	Engage with and discuss stories
Experience sounds/rhymes	Develop phonological awareness
Scribble and make marks	Give increasing meaning to marks
Experience quantity	Develop stronger number sense
Match and sort	Compare, classify and explain simply
Explore objects	Investigate properties
Play alongside others	Develop cooperative play
Attempt self-care	Become increasingly independent
Notice the environment	Ask questions about the environment
Explore creatively	Represent experiences and ideas
Follow routines	Take responsibility within routines

Core Nursery movement: EXPLORE -> NOTICE -> NAME -> DESCRIBE -> REPRESENT -> CONNECT

Critical Nursery Literacy Principle

Nursery literacy is strong but developmentally appropriate. It deliberately develops oral language, vocabulary, listening, attention, story comprehension, nursery rhymes, songs, rhythm, rhyme, alliteration, environmental sounds, voice sounds, oral blending experiences where appropriate, book knowledge, name recognition, drawing, mark-making, fine-motor development and meaningful early writing behaviours. Nursery does not race children through Reception-level phonics merely to appear academically advanced.

First-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	Welcome to Nursery	Belonging, routines and independence
2	All About Me	Identity, language and representation
3	My Body and My Senses	Body knowledge, movement and investigation
4	Keeping Myself Healthy	Self-care, hygiene and healthy routines
5	My Feelings and Friendships	Emotional literacy and relationships
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive review
7	My Family and Home	Relationships, language and belonging
8	My School and Community	People, places and responsibility
9	Colours, Shapes and Patterns Around Me	Mathematical noticing and representation
10	Numbers in My World	Early number sense and quantity
11	Plants and Living Things	Observation, growth and stewardship
12	Christmas - Love, Giving and Celebration	Faith, story and creative expression
13	Look How I Have Grown	Reflection, consolidation and progression

Week 1 - Welcome to Nursery

Children establish security while taking greater responsibility for belongings and routines. Vocabulary: welcome, Nursery, teacher, friend, choose, help, please, thank you, finished, tidy, wait, turn. Develop choice, turn-taking, personal space, help-seeking, movement, fine-motor manipulation, daily stories, name recognition, rhymes, listening games, environmental sounds, meaningful mark-making, natural counting, matching and positional language. Practical Life: choose, carry, complete and restore. Character: Belonging and Respect.

Week 2 - All About Me

Develop detailed awareness of identity and communication about self. Vocabulary: name, age, family, like, favourite, same, different, special. Build positive identity, preferences and confidence. Recognise own name increasingly, notice meaningful letters without formal memorisation, create an All About Me class book, draw self and explain marks. Explore age-related quantity, height informally, photographs and same/different. Character: Value and Respect.

Week 3 - My Body and My Senses

Deepen body knowledge and investigate senses. Vocabulary includes head, shoulder, knee, elbow, wrist, ankle, eyes, ears, nose, tongue, skin, see, hear, smell, taste, touch, smooth, rough, loud, quiet, sweet, soft, hard. Develop coordination, balance, jumping, running, throwing/catching and finger strength. Investigate sight, sound, texture, smell and safe taste. Introduce simple body autonomy: 'My body belongs to me.' Character: Gratitude and Respect.

Week 4 - Keeping Myself Healthy

Children understand and participate increasingly in health routines. Vocabulary: healthy, wash, soap, clean, teeth, brush, food, water, exercise, sleep, rest. Sequence simple routines, practise handwashing, self-feeding, dressing, movement and care activities. Discuss washing, brushing teeth, water, food, sleep and movement without simplistic 'bad food' labels. Practical Life: washing, wiping, pouring, serving, dressing and cleaning. Character: Responsibility.

Week 5 - My Feelings and Friendships

Develop emotional vocabulary and positive participation with others. Vocabulary: happy, sad, angry, worried, excited, calm, friend, share, turn, sorry, help. Recognise emotions, express needs, begin negotiating, take turns, cooperate and repair relationships with support. Use stories, character discussion, puppets, role play, faces, music/mood and calming strategies. Character: Kindness, Forgiveness and Friendship.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Revisit routines, identity, body, senses, health, feelings, friendship, language, books, phonological awareness, number, movement and independence. Review security, spoken language, story attention, sound/rhyme noticing, emerging number understanding, social play, self-care and children's interests.

Week 7 - My Family and Home

Use richer language to describe familiar relationships and home experiences. Vocabulary: family, parent, brother, sister, baby, grandmother, grandfather, aunt, uncle, home, room. Use family stories, photographs where available, adult-scribed descriptions and role-play storytelling. Explore meaningful counting, household comparison, position, different families/homes, family routines and past/present. Practical Life: folding, wiping, table setting and sorting. Character: Love and Care.

Week 8 - My School and Community

Children understand belonging to a community of people, places, responsibilities and relationships. Vocabulary may include community, school, teacher, cook, cleaner, driver, nurse, market, shop, road, church according to context. Explore school, appropriate staff roles, familiar community places, environmental print, role-play writing, counting/sorting, routes and model building. Use Angel Montessori School and suitable Owo photographs. Character: Service and Respect.

Week 9 - Colours, Shapes and Patterns Around Me

Children notice, compare, classify and represent visual/spatial relationships. Explore circle, triangle, square, rectangle where appropriate, curved/straight, same/different, size, position and simple repeating patterns. Shapes appear in varied sizes, orientations, colours and materials. Use construction, pegging, threading, drawing, environmental shape hunts, printing, fabric and collage. Include appropriate Nigerian fabric/design patterns. Character: Order and Appreciation.

Week 10 - Numbers in My World

Develop meaningful number sense through quantities, actions and everyday experiences rather than numeral recitation. Provide one-to-one correspondence, small quantities, object counting, cardinality, more/fewer, same amount, subitising small quantities

where appropriate and number songs/routines. Count jumps, steps, throws and practical items. If a child can chant numbers but cannot reliably give three objects, conceptual understanding still needs development. Character: Patience and Perseverance.

Week 11 - Plants and Living Things

Observe living things more carefully and begin explaining simple changes. Vocabulary: living, plant, seed, root, stem, leaf, flower, soil, water, sunlight, grow. Plant seeds, observe, compare, ask questions and care for plants. Explore taller/shorter, more/fewer leaves and growth sequence. Use observation drawing and adult-scribed comments. Use locally meaningful plants/crops where practical. Character: Stewardship and Patience.

Week 12 - Christmas: Love, Giving and Celebration

Encounter Christmas through Christian story, language, music, creativity, relationships and generosity. Vocabulary: Christmas, Jesus, Mary, Joseph, baby, gift, love, joy, give, thankful. Share an age-appropriate Nativity story, simple sequencing, songs, role play, counting, patterns, shape, sorting, family celebration discussion and child-led art. Character: Love, Joy, Gratitude and Giving.

Week 13 - Look How I Have Grown

Consolidation and reflection rather than examination. Revisit favourite books, rhymes, stories, sound games, number experiences, body movement, Practical Life, role play, plants, art, construction and outdoors. Review language, explanation, story engagement, sound awareness, quantity understanding, representation, cooperative play and independence across all seven EYFS areas.

Nursery First-Term Communication Spine

Adults deliberately introduce useful vocabulary through sustained interaction rather than vocabulary testing. Model descriptive and reasoning language: 'You chose the long red block'; 'Your tower is taller than mine'; 'Tell me what happened to the plant'; 'I wonder why he feels sad'; 'What could we try?'

Nursery First-Term Phonological Awareness

Children regularly experience environmental sounds, instrumental sounds, body percussion, rhythm and rhyme, playful alliteration, voice sounds and sensitive oral blending where developmentally ready. These create strong foundations for later systematic phonics.

Nursery First-Term Literacy Entitlement

Every Nursery child experiences books daily: fiction, rhymes, traditional tales, Nigerian/African stories, information books, picture books, varied families and child interests. Children listen, talk, predict, join refrains, retell, role-play, sequence, draw, make marks and increasingly communicate meaning. Writing begins with meaning, not pages of copied letters.

Nursery First-Term Mathematics Spine

Establish strong foundations in quantity, one-to-one correspondence, cardinality, small-number recognition, subitising experiences, comparison, more/fewer, same/different, matching, sorting, shape, space, position, pattern, size and sequence. Mathematics appears throughout construction, snack, songs, outdoors, stories, tidying, role play, Practical Life and adult-guided activity.

Nursery Practical Life Progression

Crèche ended with LET ME TRY. Nursery develops **I CAN DO MORE**. Children increasingly manage belongings, carry trays, pour, transfer, wipe, sweep, wash, serve, fold, sort, open/close, fasten, restore resources, care for plants, prepare simple activities and take classroom responsibility. Practical Life supports concentration, coordination, order, independence, confidence and responsibility.

Continuous Provision

Provide rich accessible areas for Books & Communication, Writing/Mark-Making, Mathematics, Construction, Small World, Role Play, Creative Arts, Practical Life, Investigation, Sensorial Exploration, Fine-Motor Development and Outdoor Learning. Weekly themes should not close down children's other interests.

Outdoor Curriculum

Outdoor learning includes running, balancing, climbing, throwing, catching, large construction, water, sand where available, gardening, nature observation, mark-making, mathematics, role play, sound exploration and collaborative play. **OUTDOORS IS A LEARNING ENVIRONMENT - NOT ONLY BREAK TIME.**

Christian Character Spine

First Term intentionally develops Belonging, Respect, Gratitude, Responsibility, Kindness, Forgiveness, Love, Service, Patience, Perseverance, Stewardship, Joy and Giving. Faith should be evident in relationships and actions, not merely displays.

Nigerian and Owo Context

Nursery children encounter real names, languages, families, homes, Angel Montessori School, Owo, community occupations, foods, plants, music, stories, patterns, clothing, weather and everyday Nigerian experiences, while also being exposed appropriately to the wider world. **ROOTED LOCALLY - OPEN TO THE WORLD.**

Inclusion and SEND

Nursery expectations are ambitious without being uniform. Children may need different language support, sensory access, adult scaffolding, visual support, physical adaptations, communication methods, processing time, challenge or emotional support. Ask what barrier prevents participation. **ADAPT ACCESS - DO NOT REMOVE ENTITLEMENT.**

Parent Partnership

Useful home connections include reading, conversation, rhymes, singing, meaningful counting, sorting household objects, helping prepare meals, dressing practice, family stories, photographs, drawing, noticing numbers/signs, plant care and talking about feelings. Parents should not be pressured to reproduce school at home.

First-Term Assessment

Assessment remains **OBSERVE -> UNDERSTAND -> PLAN -> RESPOND**. Useful observations include new language, story participation, rhyme awareness, one-to-one counting, recognising small quantities, cooperative problem-solving, sustained concentration, independent self-care, new physical capability, creative representation or significant misconceptions. Record what matters; not every activity requires photographic evidence.

End-of-First-Term Nursery Expectations

Depending on starting point and development, children increasingly communicate richly, listen longer, converse, enjoy/discuss stories, join songs/rhymes, notice sounds/rhyme, recognise own name meaningfully, make intentional marks, understand meaningful quantities, count with developing one-to-one correspondence, compare/sort, notice pattern/shape, move with increasing coordination, develop fine-motor control, cooperate, communicate emotions, investigate living things, represent ideas creatively, take responsibility and perform familiar Practical Life routines more independently. These are developmental expectations, not pass/fail criteria.

Progression Into Second Term

First Term establishes **I BELONG -> I COMMUNICATE -> I NOTICE -> I REPRESENT**. Second Term moves towards **I QUESTION -> I INVESTIGATE -> I COMPARE -> I EXPLAIN -> I SOLVE**, deepening community, occupations, transport, materials, forces/movement, animals, habitats, food, growth, weather, technology, mathematical reasoning, storytelling and collaborative problem-solving.

Nursery First-Term Declaration

We will protect Early Years principles while challenging children to grow. We will speak with them, give them words worth learning, read every day, sing, rhyme, listen, count things that matter, investigate, compare, build, create, tell stories, encourage questions, allow mistakes and another attempt, develop friendships and self-regulation, provide real responsibilities, strengthen independence, connect learning to Owo and Nigeria, widen their world, live Christian character and observe to understand. We will not confuse worksheets with rigour or early formalisation with excellence.

**CONFIDENT • COMMUNICATIVE • CURIOUS • THOUGHTFUL • CREATIVE • CAPABLE • INDEPENDENT • READY TO KEEP
LEARNING**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM & SCHEME OF LEARNING

PART III - NURSERY CURRICULUM SECOND TERM

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Second-Term Curriculum Intent

First Term established **I BELONG -> I COMMUNICATE -> I NOTICE -> I REPRESENT**. Second Term deliberately develops **I QUESTION -> I INVESTIGATE -> I COMPARE -> I EXPLAIN -> I SOLVE**. Children move beyond simply noticing their environment towards investigating relationships, making comparisons, predicting, describing what happens and attempting solutions through **PLAY + LANGUAGE + INVESTIGATION + REPRESENTATION + REFLECTION**.

Progression From First Term

First Term	Second Term Progression
Name familiar things	Describe features and functions
Answer simple questions	Ask and respond to increasingly varied questions
Listen to stories	Retell and discuss stories
Notice rhyme/sound	Discriminate and manipulate sounds increasingly
Make meaningful marks	Use marks to communicate ideas
Count meaningful objects	Compare quantities and solve simple practical problems
Notice shapes/patterns	Describe, continue and create patterns
Observe living things	Compare and investigate living things
Explore materials	Investigate properties and changes
Play with others	Collaborate towards shared purposes
Attempt routines	Manage more routines independently
Notice community	Understand simple community roles and relationships

Progression: NOTICE -> QUESTION -> INVESTIGATE -> TALK -> REPRESENT -> APPLY

Second-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	People Who Help Our Community	Roles, service and community
2	Transport and Journeys	Movement, routes and positional language
3	Materials Around Us	Properties, sorting and investigation
4	Push, Pull, Roll and Slide	Forces through practical exploration
5	Animals Around Us	Classification, features and care
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive assessment and review
7	Where Animals Live	Habitats, comparison and adaptation
8	Food, Farms and Markets	Origins, community and healthy experiences
9	Weather and Our Environment	Observation, change and recording
10	Building, Making and Problem-Solving	Design, construction and reasoning
11	Things That Work	Cause, effect and simple technology
12	Stories, Music and Our Culture	Narrative, language and cultural expression
13	What Have We Discovered?	Reflection, explanation and consolidation

Week 1 - People Who Help Our Community

Deepen understanding of familiar occupations: what people do, why work matters and tools used. Vocabulary: community, job, work, service, teacher, doctor, nurse, driver, farmer, trader, builder, cleaner, tool. Use community stories, environmental print, role-play appointments/messages/lists/signs, meaningful counting, real school workers and familiar Owo occupations. Practical Life: sweeping, wiping, serving, sorting and organising. Character: Service and Respect.

Week 2 - Transport and Journeys

Investigate movement from place to place. Vocabulary: transport, journey, road, wheel, passenger, driver, move, travel, near, far, route, fast, slow. Describe journeys; explore forward/backward/around/through/under/over/near/far, routes, simple maps, obstacle courses and wheeled play. Teach simple road safety and use transport genuinely encountered around Owo. Character: Patience and Responsibility.

Week 3 - Materials Around Us

Investigate safe familiar materials and their properties. Vocabulary: wood, metal, plastic, fabric, paper, glass, hard, soft, rough, smooth, bend, strong. Glass is adult-managed/images only. Compare, sort and explain choices; explore texture, bending, strength and effects of water. Use information books, labels, collage, construction, textiles, folding, tearing and sorting. Character: Care and Responsibility.

Week 4 - Push, Pull, Roll and Slide

Investigate movement practically. Vocabulary: push, pull, roll, slide, move, stop, fast, slow, far, near, ramp, steep. Explore cars on ramps, balls, surfaces, pushing, pulling, rolling and sliding. Encourage prediction and description. Compare distance, speed and ramp height informally; draw investigation records with adult-scribed comments. Character: Curiosity and Perseverance.

Week 5 - Animals Around Us

Compare familiar animals using observable features. Vocabulary may include animal, mammal in adult modelling, bird, fish, insect, feather, fur, scales, wing, leg, tail. Compare covering, movement, size, legs, sounds, food and young; sort and explain choices. Use familiar Nigerian animals and wider examples, stories, information books, rhymes, movement, model-making and drawing. Character: Gentleness and Care.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Revisit community, transport, materials, movement, animals, phonological awareness, storytelling, number, shape, language, Practical Life and social development. Identify understanding, vocabulary, questions, problem-solving, number security, cooperative play and areas needing further teaching.

Week 7 - Where Animals Live

Investigate relationships between animals and environments. Vocabulary: habitat, home, nest, burrow, pond, tree, water, land, shelter. Explore familiar associations without rigid oversimplification; sort by environment and use position language. Read habitat texts, create story maps and construct habitats. Ask what animals might need and why. Character: Care and Stewardship.

Week 8 - Food, Farms and Markets

Investigate familiar food origins and journeys. Vocabulary: farm, farmer, crop, market, trader, fruit, vegetable, grain, food, buy, sell, money. Use locally meaningful foods such as yam, cassava, maize, rice, beans, plantain, banana, orange and vegetables as appropriate. Explore GROW -> HARVEST -> MARKET -> HOME -> EAT experientially. Use counting, comparison, pretend money, sorting, lists, signs and safe preparation. Character: Gratitude and Respect for Work.

Week 9 - Weather and Our Environment

Observe weather over time and notice patterns/change. Vocabulary: weather, sunny, cloudy, rain, windy, hot, warm, cool, wet, dry, change. Make daily observations and a simple class weather record; compare observations where meaningful. Use stories, dictated observations, movement, sound and painting. Centre weather children actually experience rather than imported snow activities. Character: Gratitude and Stewardship.

Week 10 - Building, Making and Problem-Solving

Children increasingly **IMAGINE -> BUILD -> TEST -> CHANGE -> TRY AGAIN**. Vocabulary: plan, build, join, strong, tall, balance, fix, change, problem, solution. Explore shape, space, size, length, position, pattern, balance and joining materials. Draw simple plans, test structures, explain and modify. Use open-ended making rather than identical crafts. Character: Perseverance and Creativity.

Week 11 - Things That Work

Investigate safe simple technology and cause-effect systems. Vocabulary: machine, tool, button, switch, wheel, turn, press, open, close, work, electricity. Explore torches, mechanical toys, wheels, gears where available, buttons and adult-supported equipment. Use first/next/then language, information texts and simple purposeful digital experiences. Never encourage independent mains-electricity experimentation. Character: Wisdom and Responsibility.

Week 12 - Stories, Music and Our Culture

Deepen narrative language and cultural identity. Vocabulary: character, story, beginning, next, end, song, rhythm, beat, tradition. Retell, sequence, predict, discuss characters, alter story parts and create oral stories. Develop rhyme, rhythm, alliteration, listening discrimination and oral sound play. Include Yoruba/Nigerian songs, drumming, dance, drama, pattern, puppetry and Nigerian/African stories alongside wider literature. Character: Joy, Identity and Respect.

Week 13 - What Have We Discovered?

Revisit the term through investigation, explanation and representation rather than formal examination. Return to favourite investigations, stories, sound games, number challenges, construction, community role play, animals/habitats, weather, music and Practical Life. Review explanation, questions, vocabulary, retelling, sound awareness, meaningful marks, number, pattern, observation, prediction, collaboration, persistence, movement, creative representation and independence.

Second-Term Communication & Language Spine

Interaction increasingly moves from 'What is this?' towards 'Tell me about it', 'How are these different?', 'Why did you put those together?', 'What do you think might happen?', 'How could we fix it?', 'What happened first?' and 'Can you tell me another way?' The aim is sustained shared thinking, not interrogation.

Phonological Awareness Progression

Continue environmental sound discrimination -> instrumental sounds -> body percussion -> rhythm and rhyme -> alliteration -> voice sounds -> oral blending and segmenting experiences where developmentally appropriate. Children increasingly notice meaningful print and letters in names/environment. Sound should first be heard, enjoyed, distinguished and manipulated orally rather than turned automatically into worksheets.

Second-Term Literacy Progression

Children increasingly listen to longer stories, answer/ask questions, predict, retell, sequence, discuss characters, join repeated language, invent oral stories, recognise meaningful print, use drawing/marks to communicate and attempt writing-like forms naturally. Preserve **THOUGHT -> LANGUAGE -> MEANING -> MARK**.

Second-Term Mathematics Spine

Deepen number through small quantities, one-to-one correspondence, cardinality, subitising, comparison, more/fewer and composition of small numbers through practical experience. Develop pattern through copy/continue/notice/create; shape/space through construction, rotation, position, fit and routes; measure through length, height, capacity, weight and time/order. Mathematical thinking increasingly includes notice, compare, predict, check and explain.

Practical Life - Second Term

First Term: I CAN DO MORE. Second Term: **I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY**. Children increasingly manage belongings, restore resources, serve, pour, wipe, sweep, wash, fold, sort, prepare, carry, fasten, care for plants, participate in food preparation, organise workspaces and appropriately help peers. Independence means adults know when to help and when to wait.

Continuous Provision

Maintain rich language, books, mark-making, mathematics, construction, small world, role play, creative arts, Practical Life, investigation, sensory, fine-motor and outdoor areas. Enhancements may include community role play, transport investigation, materials laboratory, ramps, habitats, market, weather station, construction workshop and simple technology.

Outdoor Learning

Provide large movement, routes, transport, ramps, distance comparison, construction, weather observation, plant care, animal/minibeast observation, water, measurement, collaboration, problem-solving and large-scale mark-making. Deliberately take language, mathematics and investigation outdoors.

Nigerian & Owo Curriculum Connection

Begin enquiry with Angel Montessori School, Owo, local roads, transport, markets, farms, foods, occupations, plants, animals, weather, materials, music, stories and Yoruba/Nigerian cultural experiences, then widen children's experience. **LOCAL KNOWLEDGE IS NOT LESS ACADEMIC KNOWLEDGE**.

Christian Character Spine

Develop Service, Patience, Responsibility, Perseverance, Gentleness, Stewardship, Gratitude, Creativity, Wisdom, Joy and Respect through real situations.

Inclusion and SEND

A child can investigate without necessarily explaining verbally. Responses may use gesture, choice, objects, movement, drawing, sign, home language, AAC where applicable or spoken language. Differentiate complexity, language, resources, sensory demand, physical access, time, group size and support. **DIFFERENT ROUTE - SHARED ENTITLEMENT**.

Parent Partnership

Home connections may include talking about jobs and journeys, sorting materials, rolling objects down safe slopes, discussing animals, visiting markets, preparing food, observing weather, building with boxes, reading, rhyming, meaningful counting and household routines. Parents contribute valuable knowledge about languages, culture, interests, experiences, questions and independence.

Second-Term Assessment

Assessment remains **OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND**. High-value observations include significant questions, spontaneous vocabulary, story retelling, rhyme noticing, quantity problem-solving, small-amount subitising, pattern continuation, construction modification, prediction, sorting explanation, successful collaboration and new independence. Assessment should answer: **WHAT SHOULD WE TEACH OR PROVIDE NEXT?**

End-of-Second-Term Expectations

Depending on starting point and development, children increasingly use richer vocabulary, sustain interaction, ask questions, describe observations, retell stories, play with sounds, communicate through marks, understand small quantities more securely, compare quantities, create patterns, use positional/comparative language, investigate materials, predict outcomes, notice cause/effect, compare living things, develop community knowledge, solve practical problems, collaborate, persist, represent ideas creatively and manage greater responsibility. These are developmental expectations, not pass/fail criteria.

Progression Into Third Term

First Term: BELONG -> COMMUNICATE -> NOTICE -> REPRESENT. Second Term: QUESTION -> INVESTIGATE -> COMPARE -> EXPLAIN -> SOLVE. Third Term develops **CONNECT -> APPLY -> CREATE -> REFLECT -> PREPARE FOR RECEPTION**, deepening growth/change, nature, wider-world knowledge, story creation, mathematical problem-solving, sound awareness, meaningful early writing, design, collaboration, independence, self-regulation and Reception transition.

Nursery Second-Term Declaration

We will encourage questions without always giving answers immediately. We will investigate, compare, predict, test and discuss what happened. We will read, retell, rhyme and play with sounds. We will count with understanding, notice patterns, build, test, change ideas and try again. We will explore Owo and Nigeria while widening children's world. We will develop responsibility, cooperation, creativity and thinking while protecting meaningful Early Years learning.

**QUESTIONERS • INVESTIGATORS • COMMUNICATORS • PROBLEM-SOLVERS • CREATORS • RESPONSIBLE LEARNERS •
INDEPENDENT THINKERS**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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Second-Term Journey: Question -> Investigate -> Compare -> Explain -> Solve

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ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM & SCHEME OF LEARNING

PART III - NURSERY CURRICULUM THIRD TERM

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Third-Term Curriculum Intent

Third Term completes the Nursery journey and provides a deliberate developmental bridge into Reception. First Term: **BELONG -> COMMUNICATE -> NOTICE -> REPRESENT**. Second Term: **QUESTION -> INVESTIGATE -> COMPARE -> EXPLAIN -> SOLVE**. Third Term: **CONNECT -> APPLY -> CREATE -> REFLECT -> PREPARE**. The term strengthens communication, self-regulation, physical development, phonological awareness, storytelling, meaningful mark-making, number sense, mathematical thinking, curiosity, problem-solving, creativity, Practical Life and independence without prematurely converting Nursery into Reception.

The Nursery to Reception Bridge

Nursery Development	Third-Term Progression
Communicate ideas	Explain ideas increasingly clearly
Listen to stories	Retell, predict and create stories
Hear rhyme and sounds	Manipulate sounds increasingly
Make meaningful marks	Use marks/writing attempts for purposes
Count objects	Apply number understanding practically
Notice quantities	Compare and reason about quantities
Notice pattern	Continue and create patterns
Explore shape	Use shape and space in construction/problems
Investigate	Predict, test and explain
Play collaboratively	Plan and create with others
Follow routines	Manage routines increasingly independently
Ask for help	Attempt first and seek help appropriately
Participate in self-care	Take greater responsibility for self-care
Explore ideas	Represent and revisit ideas

Transition principle: SECURE FOUNDATIONS BEFORE ACCELERATION

Third-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	Look How Things Grow	Growth, change and sequencing
2	Life Cycles Around Us	Change over time and observation
3	Our Amazing Earth	Environment, land, water and stewardship
4	Nigeria - My Country	Identity, place and belonging
5	Africa and the Wider World	Widening geographical and cultural awareness
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive review
7	Numbers Help Us Solve Problems	Mathematical reasoning
8	Shapes, Measures and Patterns	Spatial reasoning and comparison
9	I Am a Storyteller	Narrative, language and imagination
10	I Can Plan, Make and Improve	Design, creativity and problem-solving
11	Sounds, Words and Meaningful Marks	Literacy foundations
12	I Can Do More for Myself	Independence and Reception readiness
13	Moving Forward to Reception	Reflection, celebration and transition

Week 1 - Look How Things Grow

Deepen understanding that living things change over time. Vocabulary: grow, change, seed, shoot, root, stem, leaf, flower, bigger, taller, before, after. Observe and compare plants, notice change over days, use informal measurement, sequence, plant stories, observation drawings and adult-scribed comments. Practical Life includes watering and care. Character: Patience and Stewardship.

Week 2 - Life Cycles Around Us

Encounter patterns of growth and change through developmentally appropriate examples such as plant, butterfly, frog, chicken and human growth. Vocabulary: baby, young, adult, egg, grow, change, first, next, later. Use photographs, books, models, sequencing, retelling, movement, drawing, models and collage. The goal is conceptual encounter, not memorising scientific terminology. Character: Wonder and Patience.

Week 3 - Our Amazing Earth

Develop introductory understanding of the natural world and responsibility for it. Vocabulary: Earth, land, water, river, sea, soil, tree, sky, environment, clean, care. Explore land/water, soil, plants, weather, natural materials and environmental care without abstract planetary science. Sort natural materials, compare, pattern and count; use nature stories and outdoor observation. Character: Stewardship.

Week 4 - Nigeria: My Country

Strengthen identity through **ME -> FAMILY -> SCHOOL -> OWO -> NIGERIA**. Vocabulary: Nigeria, country, Owo, town, flag, green, white, people, language, home. Encounter the flag, familiar places, foods, music, clothing, languages, landscapes, occupations, transport and celebrations while communicating Nigeria's diversity. Use Nigerian stories, names, songs, environmental print and open-ended creative work. Character: Gratitude, Respect and Belonging.

Week 5 - Africa and the Wider World

Widen awareness through Owo -> Nigeria -> Africa -> Wider World. Africa is never taught as one country or culture. Children encounter diversity in people, homes, cities, villages, landscapes, languages, music, food, clothing, animals and environments. Use globes, maps, photographs and books exploratorily without map memorisation. Encourage respectful comparison and curiosity.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Revisit growth, life cycles, nature, Nigeria, Africa, language, books, sound awareness, number, Practical Life, movement, creativity and social development. Review progression and identify priorities for Reception transition.

Week 7 - Numbers Help Us Solve Problems

Apply number understanding to concrete practical problems involving sharing, combining/separating small groups, matching, comparison, one more/one fewer, small-number composition and subitising where secure. Vocabulary: how many, more, fewer, same, enough, another, altogether, left. Use counting stories, movement and distributing resources. Formal written arithmetic is not the Nursery objective. Character: Perseverance and Fairness.

Week 8 - Shapes, Measures and Patterns

Apply mathematical thinking through construction, comparison and everyday problems. Explore 2D shapes, 3D objects through play, length, height, capacity, weight, position, pattern and sequence. Use longer/shorter, taller, heavier/lighter, full/empty, half-full informally, behind, between and next to. Investigate containers, towers, patterns and fitting blocks. Character: Order and Persistence.

Week 9 - I Am a Storyteller

Organise experiences and imagination into narratives. Develop character, setting, event, sequence, beginning, next and ending naturally without testing terminology. Children retell, invent, change, dictate, act and discuss stories. Continue rhyme, rhythm, alliteration, oral blending/segmenting where appropriate and sound discrimination. Include Nigerian/Yoruba oral storytelling traditions. Character: Confidence and Creativity.

Week 10 - I Can Plan, Make and Improve

Undertake increasingly sustained projects using **IDEA -> PLAN -> MAKE -> TEST -> CHANGE -> EXPLAIN**. Vocabulary: idea, plan, make, join, test, change, improve, strong, problem, solution. Use open-ended construction, model-making, paint, textiles and loose parts; investigate materials, shape, space, measure, pattern and balance. Draw plans, make labels and dictate explanations. Products should not all look identical. Character: Creativity, Cooperation and Perseverance.

Week 11 - Sounds, Words and Meaningful Marks

Consolidate literacy foundations without importing a Reception phonics programme. Continue rhyme, alliteration, sound discrimination, voice sounds, oral blending and oral segmenting where appropriate. Notice own/familiar names, labels, signs, books, logos and meaningful environmental letters. Develop controlled mark-making, drawing, lines, curves, patterns, developmentally appropriate name attempts and meaningful pretend writing. Fine motor: threading, pegging, dough, tongs, cutting and manipulation. **WRITING MUST GROW FROM COMMUNICATION AND MEANING.**

Week 12 - I Can Do More for Myself

Prepare for Reception through independence, self-regulation and responsibility rather than accelerated worksheets. Children increasingly manage belongings, hygiene/toilet routines with appropriate independence, eating/drinking, simple clothing/fastenings, resources, spills and workspaces; wait, listen, follow routines, transition between activities, cooperate, manage disappointment with support and attempt solutions. **INDEPENDENCE IS ACADEMIC PREPARATION TOO.** Character: Responsibility and Confidence.

Week 13 - Moving Forward to Reception

Celebrate development and create a secure transition without pass/fail graduation testing. Where practical, visit Reception, meet adults, explore the room, see familiar resources, share a story, participate briefly and return to Nursery. Allow excitement and worry. Create an 'Our Nursery Year' book using drawings, permitted photographs and dictated comments. Revisit mathematics and celebrate through music, movement, art and story. Character: Courage, Gratitude and Hope.

Third-Term Communication Spine

Adult interaction increasingly supports reasoning: 'Tell me more', 'What makes you think that?', 'What could happen next?', 'How are they the same/different?', 'What did you try?', 'Did it work?', 'What could you change?', 'Can you explain your idea?' Children's thinking is valued even before grammar is perfect.

Nursery Year-End Phonological Awareness

Children receive rich repeated opportunities to listen carefully, discriminate environmental/instrumental sounds, produce body percussion, join rhythm/rhyme, notice rhyming patterns, enjoy alliteration, experiment with voice sounds, hear words as sound sequences and experience oral blending/segmenting where appropriate. Some letter-sound knowledge may arise meaningfully, but Nursery remains a foundation for Reception systematic synthetic phonics.

Nursery Year-End Literacy Entitlement

Every child experiences daily stories, quality picture books, information books, rhymes, poetry/song, traditional tales, Nigerian stories, African stories, wider-world literature, storytelling, role play, drawing, mark-making, meaningful print, name recognition, fine-motor preparation and sound play. Progression: **LISTEN -> TALK -> IMAGINE -> REPRESENT -> GIVE MEANING -> BEGIN TO WRITE.**

Nursery Year-End Mathematics Entitlement

Children experience number, quantity, one-to-one correspondence, cardinality, subitising, comparison, small-number composition, more/fewer, pattern, shape, space, position, length, height, weight, capacity, sequence and practical problem-solving. Progression: **EXPERIENCE -> NOTICE -> COMPARE -> REPRESENT -> REASON -> APPLY.**

Practical Life - End-of-Nursery Progression

Crèche First Term: DO WITH ME -> Crèche Second: LET ME HELP -> Crèche Third: LET ME TRY -> Nursery First: I CAN DO MORE -> Nursery Second: I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY -> Nursery Third: **I AM BECOMING INDEPENDENT.**

Reception Readiness - The AMES Position

Reception readiness is not primarily writing A-Z, reading long word lists, completing worksheets, counting artificially high or sitting silently for long periods. It includes communication, listening, conversation, books, sound play, meaningful marks, quantity understanding, practical problem-solving, confident movement, tool manipulation, personal needs, routines, participation, increasing emotional regulation, concentration, persistence, questioning, choice and appropriate help-seeking. **READY DOES NOT MEAN FINISHED.**

Continuous Provision - Third Term

Maintain books, mark-making, mathematics, construction, small world, role play, creative arts, Practical Life, investigation, sensory experiences, fine-motor resources and outdoor learning throughout the term. Do not remove play areas merely because Reception approaches.

Outdoor Curriculum

Include growth observation, gardening, nature, large construction, mathematical trails, routes, water/capacity, physical challenge, collaborative games, storytelling, large-scale art, sound investigation, shadow/light, problem-solving and environmental responsibility. Outdoor learning remains curriculum until the final Nursery day.

Nigerian, African and Global Identity

By year end children encounter: I am me; I belong to a family; I belong to Angel Montessori School; our school is in Owo; Owo is in Nigeria; Nigeria is a country in Africa; Africa contains many countries and peoples; there is a wider world. Progression: **IDENTITY -> BELONGING -> PLACE -> COUNTRY -> CONTINENT -> WORLD.**

Christian Character - Year-End Spine

Across Nursery children experience love, kindness, respect, gratitude, responsibility, service, patience, perseverance, gentleness, stewardship, wisdom, joy, fairness, cooperation, courage and hope. Character must be visible in adult modelling and relationships.

Inclusion and SEND - Transition

Transition identifies support needs and strengths across communication, home language, hearing, vision, sensory needs, physical/fine-motor development, social interaction, attention, self-regulation, toileting/self-care, medical needs, learning behaviours, interests, strengths and successful strategies. Transition information should answer: **What does the next teacher need to know to help this child flourish from Day One?**

Parent Partnership - Reception Transition

Encourage conversation, reading, rhymes, independence, dressing, toileting, handwashing, mealtime participation, tidying, simple responsibilities, meaningful counting, drawing, storytelling, physical activity, sleep routines and positive Reception discussion. Avoid unnecessary Reception 'entrance homework'.

Nursery to Reception Transition Profile

Summarise development across Communication & Language; PSED; Physical Development; Literacy; Mathematics; Understanding the World; Expressive Arts & Design; and Practical Life. Record how the child listens, communicates, cooperates, regulates, persists, moves, uses tools, manages self-care, engages with books/sounds/marks, understands number/shape/pattern, observes/investigates, creates and acts independently.

Complete Nursery Annual Progression

First Term - BELONG & REPRESENT: I BELONG -> I COMMUNICATE -> I NOTICE -> I REPRESENT. Second Term - INVESTIGATE & SOLVE: I QUESTION -> I INVESTIGATE -> I COMPARE -> I EXPLAIN -> I SOLVE. Third Term - CONNECT & PREPARE: I CONNECT -> I APPLY -> I CREATE -> I REFLECT -> I PREPARE. Full journey: **BELONG -> COMMUNICATE -> INVESTIGATE -> REASON -> CREATE -> BECOME INDEPENDENT -> MOVE FORWARD.**

End-of-Nursery Curriculum Entitlement

Every child leaving AMES Nursery should have experienced secure relationships, rich spoken language, daily books, songs/rhymes, phonological awareness, meaningful mark-making, number sense, mathematical reasoning, construction, investigation, nature, movement, outdoor learning, creative arts, music, storytelling, role play, Practical Life, self-care, community, Owo, Nigeria, Africa, the wider world, Christian character, problem-solving, choice, collaboration and increasing independence. **NO CHILD'S NURSERY SUCCESS SHOULD BE JUDGED PRIMARILY BY THE NUMBER OF WORKSHEETS COMPLETED.**

Nursery Curriculum Quality Test

Leadership asks whether children felt secure; adults knew them well; spoken language and books were rich; sound awareness and meaningful mathematics developed; children investigated, built, created and went outdoors; physical development and Practical Life increased independence; cooperation developed; Nigerian identity and Africa were represented authentically; Christian character was lived; SEND needs were supported; assessment improved teaching; parents were partners; and Reception transition was carefully planned. Central test: **ARE OUR CHILDREN MORE COMMUNICATIVE, CURIOUS, CAPABLE AND INDEPENDENT THAN WHEN THEY ENTERED NURSERY?**

Nursery Year-End Declaration

We helped children belong, listened to them, expanded language, surrounded them with books, sang and rhymed, developed sound awareness and meaningful marks, strengthened number sense, encouraged investigation and questions, built and created, solved problems, explored outdoors, cared for living things, strengthened friendships and self-regulation, gave real responsibilities, rooted learning in Owo and Nigeria, widened understanding towards Africa and the world, lived Christian character, recognised different developmental pathways, worked with families, allowed attempts and mistakes, and encouraged children to try again. We now prepare them to move forward because they are increasingly secure, communicative, curious, thoughtful, creative, responsible, capable, independent and ready for Reception.

**SECURE • COMMUNICATIVE • CURIOUS • THOUGHTFUL • CREATIVE • RESPONSIBLE • CAPABLE • INDEPENDENT • READY
FOR RECEPTION**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM & SCHEME OF LEARNING

PART IV - RECEPTION CURRICULUM FIRST TERM

Official Approved Curriculum Record
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Class: Reception

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Framework: EYFS for England + AMES Montessori Integration

Motto: In God We Trust

1. Reception Curriculum Position

Reception is the final stage of AMES Early Years, the final year of the EYFS, and the developmental bridge into Basic 1. It must not simply become Basic 1 taught one year early. AMES retains the seven interconnected EYFS areas alongside Montessori Practical Life, Sensorial Development, Christian Character Education, Outdoor Learning, Nigerian & Global Context, Continuous Provision, Inclusion & SEND and Parent Partnership.

2. Nursery to Reception Transition

Nursery concluded with **CONNECT -> APPLY -> CREATE -> REFLECT -> PREPARE**. Reception First Term begins **SETTLE -> SECURE -> DECODE -> REPRESENT -> REASON -> BECOME MORE INDEPENDENT**. The guiding principle is: **BUILD ON NURSERY - DO NOT RESTART CHILDREN'S LEARNING**.

Nursery	Reception Progression
Rich oral language	Increasingly precise spoken language
Enjoy stories	Discuss, retell and comprehend
Phonological awareness	Systematic synthetic phonics
Meaningful marks	Increasingly purposeful writing
Name recognition	Increasing letter/sound knowledge
Number sense	Deeper understanding of number
Small quantities	Composition and comparison
Explore patterns	Identify, continue and create patterns
Investigate	Predict, observe and explain
Cooperative play	Sustained collaborative learning
Practical Life	Increasing self-management
Ask questions	Reason and explain
Child-led exploration	Child-led + carefully sequenced teaching

3. First-Term Curriculum Intent

Priorities: belonging and emotional security; increasingly rich communication; structured systematic synthetic phonics; handwriting readiness, letter formation and meaningful composition; deeper quantity, number composition, comparison, pattern, shape and measure; and increasing independence in routines, resources, relationships and personal responsibilities.

4. Reception First-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	Welcome to Reception	Belonging, routines and baseline understanding
2	All About Me	Identity, communication and representation
3	My Body, Health and Senses	Health, movement and investigation
4	Families and Relationships	Belonging, diversity and storytelling
5	Feelings, Friendship and Self-Regulation	PSED and emotional literacy
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Review and responsive teaching
7	My School and Community	Community, roles and responsibility
8	Autumn, Weather and Change	Observation and seasonal/environmental change
9	Numbers Are Everywhere	Number sense and mathematical application
10	Shape, Space and Pattern	Spatial reasoning and mathematical language
11	Celebrations and Traditions	Culture, identity and respectful comparison
12	Christmas - The Nativity	Faith, story, language and creativity
13	Look How We Have Grown	Consolidation and reflection

Week 1 - Welcome to Reception

Develop security, belonging and confidence while establishing starting points. Build listening, conversation, help-seeking, routines, relationships, safe behaviour, turn-taking, movement, pencil/fine-motor control, daily books, rhymes, names, environmental print, sound listening, meaningful marks, quantity, counting, comparison, pattern, shape and spatial language. Practical Life includes belongings, resources and cleaning spills. Assessment principle: **KNOW THE CHILD BEFORE PLANNING THE NEXT STEP.**

5. Reception Phonics - First-Term Position

Reception begins systematic synthetic phonics. Teaching is explicit, systematic, cumulative, well sequenced and interactive, supported by decodable reading practice. Children progressively hear phonemes, recognise corresponding graphemes, blend to read, segment spoken words for spelling, form taught graphemes and read appropriate decodable words. **PHONICS MUST BE TAUGHT AS A COHERENT PROGRAMME.** The exact grapheme sequence follows the school's adopted approved systematic synthetic phonics programme rather than a random 'letter of the week'.

Week 2 - All About Me

Develop detailed communication about identity, preferences, abilities, family, language and interests. Create an All About Me book using drawing, labels where ready, meaningful writing and dictated sentences. Explore age, quantities, height, birthdays and simple class data; discuss babyhood/growth; use detailed self-portraits and expressive movement. Character: Confidence, Gratitude and Respect.

Week 3 - My Body, Health and Senses

Develop accurate body, senses and health knowledge. Vocabulary may include body, skeleton, muscle, heart, senses, sight, hearing, smell, taste, touch, healthy, exercise and hygiene. Investigate senses with prediction/observation, develop gross/fine motor control, discuss hygiene, teeth, sleep, movement, food and water, reinforce body autonomy/help-seeking and use meaningful measurement/counting. Character: Responsibility and Gratitude.

Week 4 - Families and Relationships

Develop understanding of relationships, family diversity and personal history using inclusive language. Describe family, home, routines and memories; read/retell family stories; create cards, messages, labels and captions; explore past/present, optional family photographs and traditions; use sustained non-stereotypical home role play. Character: Love, Respect and Care.

Week 5 - Feelings, Friendship and Self-Regulation

Develop emotional vocabulary including frustrated, disappointed, worried, excited, calm, proud, nervous, solution and compromise. Children increasingly recognise/communicate emotions, consider perspectives, wait, negotiate, solve simple disagreements, seek support and use calming strategies. The aim is not absence of conflict but increasingly constructive response. Character: Kindness, Forgiveness and Self-Control.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Revisit routines, communication, phonics, reading, writing, number, shape, physical development, PSED and Practical Life. Determine secure phonics knowledge, blending/oral-blending needs, number understanding, fine-motor development, language needs, SEND considerations, self-regulation and independence. Intervention follows assessment rather than labels.

Week 7 - My School and Community

Progress towards understanding relationships and responsibilities in community. Investigate school roles, familiar occupations/services/places/transport and simple maps/routes. Root learning in Angel Montessori School, Owo, familiar roads, markets, health services, places of worship and local occupations. Use signs, labels, lists, messages, captions, routes, position, counting, sorting and practical problems. Character: Service and Responsibility.

Week 8 - Autumn, Weather and Change

AMES follows EYFS but does not pretend Owo experiences British seasons as Britain does. Children may learn that autumn occurs in places such as the UK while direct environmental study focuses on Nigerian weather/seasonal patterns. Compare weather, rain, sun, wind, temperature, plants, clothing and environmental change. Core idea: **DIFFERENT PLACES CAN EXPERIENCE DIFFERENT WEATHER AND SEASONS.** Use simple weather records, descriptions and stories. Character: Curiosity and Stewardship.

Week 9 - Numbers Are Everywhere

Deepen structured but practical understanding of small numbers: counting, cardinality, subitising, composition, comparison, one more/one fewer, matching and representing quantities using objects, fingers, movement, stories, images, dot patterns, frames where appropriate, numerals and practical problems. Principle: **DEPTH BEFORE LARGE-NUMBER PERFORMANCE.**

Week 10 - Shape, Space and Pattern

Investigate circles, triangles, rectangles, squares and other meaningful shapes; 3D objects through construction; position, rotation, fit, pattern, informal symmetry, length, height and capacity. Use accurate mathematical language and varied orientations/contexts. Encourage planning, building, testing and changing. Character: Persistence and Order.

Week 11 - Celebrations and Traditions

Explore celebrations through family, Nigerian, Christian and appropriately represented wider cultural examples without stereotyping. Vocabulary: celebration, tradition, family, special, remember, together, respect. Use stories, invitations, cards, menus, labels, pattern, counting, sharing, sequence, music, dance and design. AMES maintains Christian identity while teaching respect for differing experiences.

Week 12 - Christmas: The Nativity

Encounter the Nativity with greater narrative depth. Vocabulary: Nativity, Mary, Joseph, Jesus, Bethlehem, shepherd, angel, wise men, gift, journey, stable. Listen, sequence, retell, role-play, draw and write developmentally appropriate captions/messages; explore journey, position, counting, pattern, shape and sequence through songs, drama, art and construction. Character: Love, Joy, Gratitude, Giving and Hope.

Week 13 - Look How We Have Grown

Consolidate through books, phonics, decodable reading, writing, number, mathematical games, construction, storytelling, investigation, Practical Life and outdoor learning. Review communication, PSED, physical development, phonics, reading, writing, mathematics, Understanding the World, Expressive Arts and independence. Ask: **WHAT HAS THIS CHILD LEARNED, AND WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN NEXT?**

6. Reception First-Term Reading Entitlement

Every child receives daily systematic phonics teaching, frequent blending practice, appropriately matched decodable reading material, daily high-quality stories, nursery rhymes/poetry/songs and rich books beyond independent decoding level. Learning to decode and learning to love/understand literature happen together.

7. Writing Progression

Develop gross-motor stability, shoulder/arm strength, fine-motor control, efficient tool handling, grapheme formation, oral composition, segmenting, phonically plausible spelling attempts, labels, captions, messages, lists and story-related writing. Progression: **SAY IT -> HEAR IT -> SEGMENT IT -> REPRESENT IT -> READ IT BACK.**

8. Mathematics Progression

Develop number through quantity, subitising, cardinality, composition, comparison, numeral recognition and one more/one fewer; numerical patterns through relationships, comparison, structure and reasoning; and retain rich shape, space, measure, position, capacity, length, height, pattern and construction experiences as essential mathematical foundations.

9. Practical Life - Reception

Nursery concluded I AM BECOMING INDEPENDENT. Reception begins **I CAN MANAGE MYSELF AND MY LEARNING.** Children increasingly organise belongings/workspace, select and restore resources, manage hygiene, serve, pour, clean, fasten, care for the environment, follow routines, seek help and take responsibility.

10. Continuous Provision

Retain high-quality Reading, Writing, Mathematics, Construction, Small World, Role Play, Creative Arts, Investigation, Practical Life, Fine Motor, Technology and Outdoor Learning provision. Adult-guided teaching becomes increasingly systematic, but play remains. **MORE TEACHING DOES NOT REQUIRE LESS CHILDHOOD.**

11. Outdoor Curriculum

Use outdoors for gross motor, mathematics, phonics games, storytelling, writing, construction, nature, weather, investigation, gardening, collaborative challenges, measurement, creative arts and problem-solving. Outdoors remains a curriculum environment.

12. Assessment

Gather understanding proportionately through interaction, observation, children's work, reading, phonics, mathematics, conversation, Practical Life and play. Identify what the child knows/can do, misconceptions, support needs and next teaching. Evidence collection must not become more important than teaching.

13. Inclusion & SEND

Maintain **HIGH EXPECTATION + APPROPRIATE ACCESS**. Support may include visual schedules, adapted resources, language modelling, smaller groups, sensory/physical adjustments, communication support, extra phonological practice, repetition, processing time and targeted intervention. Home language is an asset; limited English does not automatically indicate limited thinking.

14. First-Term Parent Partnership

Explain Reception learning beyond worksheet-heavy expectations. Home partnership emphasises shared reading, school reading practice, phonics guidance consistent with the adopted programme, conversation, rhymes, meaningful writing, counting, games, independence, sleep, attendance and punctuality.

15. First-Term Expectations

Depending on starting points, children increasingly settle confidently; communicate/listen; manage routines/emotions/friendships; develop movement and fine motor; participate in systematic phonics; blend/segment; recognise taught graphemes; engage with decodable text and rich literature; form graphemes and write simply; understand small-number quantities deeply; subitise, compare and compose; recognise/extend patterns; reason about shape/space; observe/investigate/create/collaborate; and take greater responsibility. These are developmental expectations, not rigid pass/fail criteria.

16. Progression Into Second Term

Reception First Term: **SETTLE -> SECURE -> DECODE -> REPRESENT -> REASON**. Second Term moves towards **DEEPEN -> READ -> COMPOSE -> INVESTIGATE -> APPLY**, strengthening phonics, decodable reading, comprehension, sentence composition, handwriting, number composition, mathematical reasoning, scientific enquiry, community/world knowledge, creative design, self-regulation and independence.

Reception First-Term Declaration

We will protect the integrity of the EYFS. We will teach systematically where systematic teaching matters. We will teach phonics properly, read to children every day, help them decode and understand, develop writers through language and meaning, teach mathematics for understanding, investigate, build, create, talk, listen, move and go outdoors. We will preserve continuous provision, strengthen Practical Life and responsibility, respect different starting points, identify barriers early, work with families, root children in Owo and Nigeria while widening their world, and live Christian character.

RECEPTION IS SCHOOL - BUT IT IS STILL EARLY YEARS.

**READERS • WRITERS • MATHEMATICIANS • COMMUNICATORS • THINKERS • CREATORS • PROBLEM-SOLVERS •
INDEPENDENT LEARNERS**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

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First-Term Journey: Settle -> Secure -> Decode -> Represent -> Reason

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ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM & SCHEME OF LEARNING

PART IV - RECEPTION CURRICULUM SECOND TERM

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Framework: EYFS for England + AMES Montessori Integration

Motto: In God We Trust

1. Second-Term Curriculum Intent

Reception First Term established **SETTLE -> SECURE -> DECODE -> REPRESENT -> REASON**. Second Term progresses towards **DEEPEN -> READ -> COMPOSE -> INVESTIGATE -> APPLY**. Children use increasingly secure foundations for systematic synthetic phonics, word reading and fluency, language comprehension, sentence composition, handwriting, number composition and reasoning, scientific enquiry, knowledge of people/places/nature, creative thinking, self-regulation and independent learning. **RECEPTION REMAINS EARLY YEARS.**

2. First Term to Second Term Progression

First Term	Second Term Progression
Settle into Reception	Manage routines increasingly independently
Recognise taught graphemes	Recall and apply taught correspondences
Begin blending	Blend increasingly automatically
Read simple decodable words	Read increasingly complex matched text
Segment orally	Segment increasingly for spelling
Write labels/captions	Compose increasingly complete sentences
Understand small quantities	Explore number composition deeply
Compare quantities	Reason about number relationships
Notice patterns	Explain and create patterns
Explore shape and space	Apply spatial reasoning
Observe	Predict and investigate
Answer questions	Explain reasoning increasingly
Cooperative play	Sustained collaborative projects
Manage belongings	Manage learning resources

Progression: KNOW -> PRACTISE -> APPLY -> EXPLAIN -> DEEPEN

3. Second-Term Curriculum Map

Week	Big Idea	Main Development
1	Back Together - Ready to Learn	Reconnection, routines and assessment
2	People Who Help Us	Community, occupations and service
3	Journeys and Transport	Movement, maps, routes and comparison
4	Materials and Their Properties	Investigation and descriptive language
5	Forces - Push, Pull and Movement	Prediction, cause and effect
6	Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility	Responsive review
7	Animals and Their Environments	Classification, habitats and care
8	Plants, Food and Growth	Living things, food origins and change
9	Number Relationships	Composition, comparison and reasoning
10	Measure, Shape and Spatial Thinking	Mathematical application
11	Machines, Technology and How Things Work	Technology, systems and responsibility
12	Stories From Nigeria and the World	Comprehension, narrative and culture
13	What Can I Explain Now?	Consolidation, application and reflection

Week 1 - Back Together: Ready to Learn

Reconnect after the holiday and re-establish learning behaviours. Develop recounting and sequencing language; re-establish routines, relationships, self-regulation and independence; revisit phonics according to the adopted programme and assess grapheme recall, oral/word blending, segmenting and decodable reading; revisit subitising, counting, cardinality, composition, comparison and pattern; resume Practical Life responsibilities. Character: Responsibility and Readiness.

Week 2 - People Who Help Us

Progress from naming occupations towards **role -> tool -> responsibility -> service**. Explore teachers, healthcare workers, farmers, traders, drivers, builders, security workers, cleaners, emergency workers and locally relevant roles without gender stereotyping. Use fiction/non-fiction, lists, labels, captions, messages, role-play records and practical mathematics. Root examples in Owo and children's families. Character: **SERVICE**.

Week 3 - Journeys and Transport

Investigate movement of people/goods and increasingly represent journeys. Vocabulary includes journey, route, destination, transport, passenger, vehicle, map, direction and distance. Compare road/water/rail/air transport without rote classification; develop positional language, simple maps, labels/captions, oral directions, obstacle routes and age-appropriate road safety. Begin with transport children genuinely encounter. Character: Patience and Responsibility.

Week 4 - Materials and Their Properties

Investigate why materials suit different purposes. Vocabulary includes material, property, transparent, waterproof, absorbent, flexible, rigid, strong, weak, rough and smooth. Safely investigate wood, metal, plastic, paper, card, fabric, rubber and adult-managed glass contexts. Ask which material works best and why; use information texts, investigation records, sorting/classifying and intentional construction. Character: Curiosity and Wise Choice.

Week 5 - Forces: Push, Pull and Movement

Investigate movement and early cause/effect through cars on ramps, balls, surfaces, pushing, pulling, rolling, sliding and ramp height. Adult vocabulary may include force, friction, speed, surface, ramp and steep without requiring formal definitions. Scientific thinking: **QUESTION -> PREDICT -> TRY -> OBSERVE -> TALK**. Compare/order distances and record observations. Character: Curiosity and Perseverance.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

No formal examination. Review phonics, decodable reading, comprehension, writing, number, mathematical reasoning, communication, PSED, physical development, investigation and Practical Life. Determine graphemes to revisit, blending automaticity, reading support, secure number concepts, language support and intervention effectiveness. **ASSESS TO IMPROVE TEACHING**.

Week 7 - Animals and Their Environments

Develop increasingly systematic knowledge of animals, habitats and basic needs. Compare features, movement, food, young, habitat and needs; introduce useful classification vocabulary naturally and avoid false rules such as 'all birds fly'. Read animal stories/information texts, write labels/captions/simple facts, sort by varied criteria, compare quantity/size and create habitats/models. Character: Care and Stewardship.

Week 8 - Plants, Food and Growth

Connect plants, growth, farming, food and human needs. Plant and observe; compare growth; discuss plant needs and food origins. Use locally meaningful crops such as yam, cassava, maize, beans, rice, plantain, vegetables and fruits. Measure informally, sequence/count/represent observations, read farming texts, draw/write observations and provide safe food preparation. Character: Gratitude, Patience and Stewardship.

Week 9 - Number Relationships

Deepen composition, comparison, subitising, one more/one fewer, informal equal groups, part-whole relationships and number bonds through practical experience. Explore numbers such as 5 in multiple compositions using objects, fingers, images and play before symbolic recording dominates. Ask 'How do you know?', 'Can you show it another way?', 'What changed?' and 'Is there another possibility?'. **MATHEMATICAL DEPTH BEFORE SPEED**.

Week 10 - Measure, Shape and Spatial Thinking

Apply mathematical language to length, height, weight, capacity, time/sequence, 2D shapes, 3D objects, properties, rotation, shape composition, maps, puzzles, routes and position. Use real problems such as comparing containers, stabilising towers and composing

pictures with shapes. Practical Life includes pouring, transferring, arranging and everyday measuring. Character: Accuracy, Patience and Persistence.

Week 11 - Machines, Technology and How Things Work

Develop age-appropriate understanding that technology is designed for purposes. Explore safe familiar technology such as torch, clock, fan, telephone, camera, computer, keyboard, mechanical devices and programmable resources where available. Children may photograph, draw digitally, type selected characters, listen to recordings and follow simple digital instructions. **CHILDREN SHOULD USE TECHNOLOGY - NOT SIMPLY CONSUME SCREENS.** Introduce ask-an-adult, privacy and stop/tell safety. Character: Wisdom and Responsibility.

Week 12 - Stories From Nigeria and the World

Deepen comprehension and narrative through Nigerian stories, Yoruba oral stories where appropriate, African literature, traditional tales, modern picture books and stories from other cultures. Predict, infer simply, retell, sequence, compare characters, explain preferences and ask questions; create stories through oral storytelling, drawing, maps, role play, shared and independent writing. African stories should also represent modern childhood, towns, cities and technology. Character: Wisdom, Respect and Imagination.

Week 13 - What Can I Explain Now?

Consolidate through explanation/application rather than conventional examinations. Revisit phonics, decodable books, stories, writing, number, mathematical challenges, investigations, construction, technology, Practical Life and outdoor learning. Ask what the child can now explain/apply independently, what remains insecure and what Third Term should prioritise.

4. Second-Term Phonics & Reading

Continue the adopted systematic synthetic phonics programme with new grapheme-phoneme correspondences according to sequence, cumulative review, oral blending, word blending, segmenting, spelling, programme-aligned tricky/common exception words and decodable reading. Independent phonics-practice books must be closely matched to taught knowledge. Children should increasingly decode rather than guess from pictures, first letters or context; pictures support meaning and enjoyment.

5. Reading Comprehension

Develop comprehension through rich vocabulary, read-aloud stories, conversation, prediction, retelling, questioning, simple inference, sequencing and discussion. AMES maintains both **BOOKS CHILDREN CAN READ** and **BOOKS CHILDREN CAN EXPERIENCE**.

6. Second-Term Writing Progression

Writing connects **ORAL LANGUAGE -> PHONICS -> HANDWRITING -> COMPOSITION**. Children increasingly say sentences, segment words, represent sounds with taught graphemes, form letters, use increasingly appropriate spacing and write labels, captions, messages, lists, simple sentences and story-related text. Adult support should preserve the child's composition.

7. Handwriting

Teach posture, stable seating, paper position, effective pencil grip, fine-motor strength, correct movement patterns and accurate formation of taught graphemes systematically. **QUALITY OF FORMATION BEFORE QUANTITY OF COPYING.**

8. Mathematics - Second-Term Progression

Deepen subitising, cardinality, composition, comparison, numerical patterns, one more/one fewer, number relationships and practical problem-solving alongside rich shape, space, measure, pattern and construction. Manipulatives remain important. Progression: **CONCRETE -> IMAGE -> LANGUAGE -> SYMBOL.**

9. Communication and Language

Language development remains whole-curriculum. Adults model precise vocabulary, complete explanations, reasoning/story/comparative/time/scientific/mathematical language and prompts such as 'Explain how you know', 'What changed?' and 'Can you describe it another way?'

10. Practical Life - Second Term

First Term: **I CAN MANAGE MYSELF AND MY LEARNING**. Second Term: **I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY FOR MY LEARNING ENVIRONMENT**. Children increasingly prepare/restore resources, organise workspaces, care for equipment, serve, pour, clean, fold, sort, manage belongings and complete responsibilities. Adults avoid doing automatically what children can increasingly do.

11. Continuous Provision

Continue Reading, Writing, Mathematics, Construction, Small World, Role Play, Creative Arts, Investigation, Technology, Practical Life, Fine Motor and Outdoor Learning. Provision evolves into academically powerful experiences: e.g., transport can include map-making, ticket writing, route planning, vehicle construction, distance comparison and journey storytelling rather than merely toy cars.

12. Outdoor Learning

Use movement, routes, maps, ramps, forces, distance, measurement, planting, weather, animal/minibeast observation, large construction, phonics trails, word hunts, storytelling, mathematical games and collaborative challenges intentionally.

13. Christian Character Spine

Develop Responsibility, Service, Patience, Curiosity, Perseverance, Care, Stewardship, Gratitude, Wisdom, Respect and Imagination through classroom life, adult modelling and reflection.

14. Inclusion & SEND

Ask **WHAT IS THE BARRIER TO LEARNING?** Support may include additional phonics practice, language modelling, vocabulary pre-teaching, visual prompts, smaller groups, sensory adaptation, movement breaks, adapted writing tools, alternative communication, repeated reading, manipulatives and adult scaffolding. Increase access without unnecessarily reducing intellectual opportunity.

15. Parent Partnership

Give clear guidance on phonics pronunciation, blending, reading practice, book routines, handwriting, meaningful writing, number games and independence. Avoid conflicting phonics methods. Home reading includes both matched child-practice books and enjoyable adult read-aloud books.

16. Second-Term Assessment

Monitor all EYFS areas with particular attention to phonics recall, blending, decodable reading, comprehension, segmenting, writing, letter formation, number composition, subitising, comparison, mathematical reasoning, language, self-regulation and independence. Assessment must produce action; e.g., grapheme recognition without blending leads to increased oral/word-blending practice, not merely more evidence collection.

17. End-of-Second-Term Expectations

Depending on starting points, children increasingly communicate confidently; listen/respond; use richer vocabulary; retell/discuss stories; apply phonics; blend increasingly automatically; read matched decodable material; segment for spelling; write increasingly complete meaningful sentences; form letters accurately; understand composition; subitise/compare/reason; apply shape/measure language; predict/investigate/describe results; understand communities; compare animals/plants/materials; use technology purposefully; collaborate; manage resources; persist and take responsibility. These are developmental curriculum expectations, not rigid pass/fail criteria.

18. Progression Into Third Term

First Term: **SETTLE -> SECURE -> DECODE -> REPRESENT -> REASON**. Second Term: **DEEPEN -> READ -> COMPOSE -> INVESTIGATE -> APPLY**. Third Term: **FLUENCY -> INDEPENDENCE -> CONNECTION -> REFLECTION -> TRANSITION**, continuing phonics, fluency, comprehension, independent composition, story writing, mathematical reasoning, number relationships, problem-solving, nature/change, Nigeria/Africa/world knowledge, collaborative projects, EYFS consolidation, transition profiling and Basic 1 readiness.

Reception Second-Term Declaration

We will deepen rather than rush. We will teach phonics systematically, practise towards automaticity, read decodable books and wonderful books children cannot yet read themselves, expand vocabulary, compose sentences orally, write for meaning, develop handwriting carefully, teach number relationships, ask children to explain, investigate materials and movement, care for living things, understand community, use technology purposefully, create, collaborate, solve problems, maintain continuous provision, go outdoors, strengthen independence, identify barriers, work with parents, maintain Nigerian identity, widen children's understanding of the world and live Christian character.

DEPTH IS NOT THE SAME AS DIFFICULTY.

**READERS • WRITERS • MATHEMATICAL THINKERS • INVESTIGATORS • COMMUNICATORS • CREATORS • RESPONSIBLE
LEARNERS • INDEPENDENT THINKERS**

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

Document Control

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Volume: III - Early Years Curriculum & Scheme of Learning

Part: IV - Reception Curriculum

Document: Reception Second Term Curriculum

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Coverage: Reception - Second Term

Progression: Reception First Term -> Reception Second Term -> Reception Third Term -> Basic 1

Second-Term Journey: Deepen -> Read -> Compose -> Investigate -> Apply

Academic Session: 2026/2027

ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III
RECEPTION CURRICULUM
THIRD TERM

Audit-Corrected Approved Edition
Version 1.1

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Class: Reception
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Status: APPROVED CONTENT — AUDIT CORRECTED
Motto: In God We Trust

Audit Correction Notice

Version 1.1 preserves the approved Reception Third Term curriculum and corrects one legal-status wording issue identified during the Volume III audit: the Early Learning Goals are statutory within England's EYFS system, while AMES adopts them in Nigeria as an end-of-Reception reference framework for its British-system programme. No termly progression has been changed.

1. Third-Term Curriculum Intent

Reception Third Term completes the Angel Montessori Early Years journey. First Term: **SETTLE -> SECURE -> DECODE -> REPRESENT -> REASON**. Second Term: **DEEPEN -> READ -> COMPOSE -> INVESTIGATE -> APPLY**. Third Term: **FLUENCY -> INDEPENDENCE -> CONNECTION -> REFLECTION -> TRANSITION**. The term continues Reception teaching properly while preparing children developmentally, academically, socially and emotionally for Basic 1. **RECEPTION DOES NOT END WHEN TRANSITION PREPARATION BEGINS.**

2. Reception to Basic 1 Bridge

Reception Development	Transition Towards Basic 1
Listen and participate	Sustain attention increasingly
Rich oral language	Explain ideas with greater precision
Systematic phonics	Apply phonics independently
Decode matched texts	Develop increasing fluency
Discuss stories	Demonstrate deeper comprehension
Write simple sentences	Compose increasingly independently
Form letters	Develop increasingly secure handwriting
Understand quantities	Apply number knowledge to problems
Explore composition	Reason about number relationships
Investigate practically	Record and explain findings
Learn through provision	Manage more structured learning
Choose resources	Organise resources independently
Cooperate in play	Collaborate on shared tasks
Manage personal routines	Take responsibility for self-management
Seek adult support	Attempt, evaluate and seek help appropriately

Transition principle: PREPARE THE CHILD FOR BASIC 1 - DO NOT TURN RECEPTION INTO BASIC 1.

3. Third-Term Curriculum Map

Week 1 - Growing and Changing

Deepen understanding that living things and people change over time. Use growth, change, mature, younger, older, past, present, future, before and after; observe and compare change; measure and represent observations. Character: Gratitude and Patience.

Week 2 - Life Cycles

Develop understanding of life cycles through observation, books, models and investigation; observe, sequence, compare, predict and explain. Character: Wonder and Care.

Week 3 - Our Environment

Understand relationships between people and environment through plants, animals, water, soil, weather, waste, cleanliness, reuse and resource care, beginning with school, home and Owo. KNOWLEDGE -> CARE -> RESPONSIBLE ACTION. Character: Stewardship.

Week 4 - Nigeria - Our Country

Deepen knowledge of Nigeria, Owo, flag, selected national symbols, people, occupations, cities/communities, languages, foods, music, clothing, landscapes and diversity. Character: Identity, Respect and Gratitude.

Week 5 - Africa and Our Wider World

Develop OWO -> ONDO STATE -> NIGERIA -> AFRICA -> WORLD using globes, maps, photographs, books, stories and purposeful digital resources; represent African life accurately and diversely. Character: Respect and Curiosity.

Week 6 - Consolidation / Calendar Flexibility

Review phonics, reading, comprehension, writing, handwriting, number, reasoning, communication, PSED, physical development, Understanding the World, Expressive Arts and Practical Life. INTERVENE WHILE THERE IS STILL TIME TO MAKE A DIFFERENCE.

Week 7 - Becoming Fluent Readers

Continue adopted SSP and cumulative review; matched decodables support accuracy, automaticity, phrasing and meaning; develop comprehension while adults continue rich read-aloud literature. THE CHILD'S DECODING LEVEL MUST NEVER BECOME THE LIMIT OF THE CHILD'S LITERARY EXPERIENCE.

Week 8 - Becoming Independent Writers

Use THINK -> SAY -> REHEARSE -> SEGMENT -> WRITE -> READ BACK -> IMPROVE; increasingly write labels, captions, messages, lists, sentences, story sequences, information and personal experiences.

Week 9 - Mathematical Problem-Solvers

Apply subitising, cardinality, composition, comparison, number relationships, one more/one fewer, doubling, sharing, grouping and appropriate odd/even patterns through meaningful problems and representations.

Week 10 - Design, Build, Test, Improve

Integrate science, mathematics, language, creativity and collaboration through NOTICE -> IMAGINE -> PLAN -> BUILD -> TEST -> IMPROVE -> EXPLAIN. Character: Creativity, Cooperation and Perseverance.

Week 11 - Looking Back at Reception

Reflect through meaningful portfolios and revisit learning; identify strengths, secure/developing learning, support needs and successful strategies. Character: Gratitude and Reflection.

Week 12 - Getting Ready for Basic 1

Prepare practically and emotionally through familiarisation, organisation, self-care, resource management, listening, task initiation, persistence, completion, independent work, collaboration and clarification. CONFIDENCE COMES FROM FAMILIARITY, NOT PRESSURE.

Week 13 - Celebration and Moving Forward

Celebrate the whole child and completion of AMES Early Years. GRADUATION IS A CELEBRATION - NOT AN ACADEMIC RANKING CEREMONY.

4. End-of-Reception EYFS Position

The Early Learning Goals (ELGs) are the statutory end-of-Reception assessment expectations **within England's EYFS system**. Angel Montessori School operates in Nigeria; they are therefore **not Nigerian statutory requirements**. AMES adopts the ELGs as its end-of-Reception reference framework within its British-system Early Years programme. The reference covers Communication & Language (Listening, Attention and Understanding; Speaking); PSED (Self-Regulation; Managing Self; Building Relationships); Physical Development (Gross Motor; Fine Motor); Literacy (Comprehension; Word Reading; Writing); Mathematics (Number; Numerical Patterns); Understanding the World (Past and Present; People, Culture and Communities; Natural World); and Expressive Arts & Design (Creating with Materials; Being Imaginative and Expressive).

5. Critical AMES ELG Principle

The ELGs are end-of-Reception assessment expectations, not a checklist for narrowing the curriculum. AMES maintains **RICH CURRICULUM FIRST -> ASSESSMENT OF LEARNING SECOND**, including shape, space, measure, technology, Practical Life, outdoors, Christian character, Nigerian identity, creative exploration and rich literature.

6. End-of-Reception Phonics Position

Progress through the adopted systematic synthetic phonics programme according to its Reception sequence. Transition records specify secure grapheme-phoneme correspondences, blending, segmenting, approach to unfamiliar decodable words, matched-book fluency and gaps requiring continued support.

7. End-of-Reception Reading

Develop increasingly strong foundations in decoding, fluency, vocabulary, comprehension, book enjoyment, story knowledge, information texts and discussion. **READING IS DECODING + LANGUAGE + MEANING + THINKING + ENJOYMENT.**

8. End-of-Reception Writing

Integrate ideas, oral language, sentence composition, phonics, spelling, letter formation, spacing and rereading through real purposes. Goal: **MEANINGFUL, INCREASINGLY INDEPENDENT AND INCREASINGLY ACCURATE WRITING.**

9. End-of-Reception Mathematics

Deepen subitising, cardinality, composition, comparison, numerical patterns, reasoning, problem-solving and representation, alongside rich shape, space, measure, position, pattern, construction, capacity, length, height, weight and time. **NUMERACY IS MORE THAN RECITING NUMBER NAMES.**

10. Communication and Language

Consider whether children increasingly listen attentively, follow increasingly complex instructions, respond appropriately, ask questions, explain, retell, use new vocabulary, sustain conversation, communicate needs and express ideas clearly enough to be understood.

11. PSED and Self-Regulation

Basic 1 readiness includes increasing ability to separate confidently, manage emotions, recover from disappointment, wait, take turns, cooperate, maintain friendships, resolve simple conflict, seek help, persist, follow expectations and manage personal needs.

SELF-REGULATION IS NOT SILENT COMPLIANCE.

12. Physical Development

Transition information includes gross-motor coordination, balance, movement, fine-motor control, pencil use, cutting, manipulation, self-care and physical access needs.

13. Practical Life - End of Reception

Third Term reaches: **I AM READY TO TAKE GREATER RESPONSIBILITY.** Children increasingly manage self, belongings, resources, workspace, hygiene, simple responsibilities, help-seeking, completion and environmental care.

14. Continuous Provision Until the End

Do not dismantle continuous provision after assessment. Reception remains Early Years until the end of the programme.

15. Transition Principle

PREPARE THE CHILD FOR BASIC 1 - DO NOT TURN RECEPTION INTO BASIC 1.

Document Control

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Correction: EYFS/ELG England-versus-Nigeria legal-status wording clarified; curriculum progression retained.

Academic Session: 2026/2027

ANGEL MONTESSORI EDUCATION SYSTEM (AMES)

VOLUME III

THE COMPLETE EARLY YEARS CURRICULUM

PART V

CURRICULUM IMPLEMENTATION & PEDAGOGY

Revised Master Edition

Chapters 1-15

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Framework: EYFS for England + AMES Requirements + Montessori-Informed Practice + Nigerian/Owo Context

Motto: In God We Trust

Revision & Audit Control Note

Version 1.1 corrects compilation and consistency issues identified during the Volume III final audit. It restores Chapter 1 to its fuller approved substance; preserves the approved substance of Chapters 2-15; standardises AMES teaching/observation terminology; clarifies the England/Nigeria status of EYFS end-of-Reception expectations; and redesigns Chapter 14 templates for practical staff use. These are audit corrections and presentation improvements, not a replacement curriculum.

Ch.	Title	Code
1	AMES Early Years Teaching Model	AMES-003-P5-C1
2	Early Years Planning Framework	AMES-003-P5-C2
3	Assessment, Observation & Evidence Framework	AMES-003-P5-C3
4	Learning Environment & Continuous Provision Standards	AMES-003-P5-C4
5	Phonics, Reading, Writing & Language Implementation	AMES-003-P5-C5
6	Mathematics Implementation Framework	AMES-003-P5-C6
7	Practical Life, Independence & Montessori Integration	AMES-003-P5-C7
8	Inclusion, SEND & Multilingual Learners	AMES-003-P5-C8
9	Safeguarding, Wellbeing, Behaviour & PSED	AMES-003-P5-C9
10	Outdoor Learning, Physical Development & Health	AMES-003-P5-C10
11	Parent Partnership & Home Learning Framework	AMES-003-P5-C11
12	Reception-to-Basic-1 Transition & School Readiness	AMES-003-P5-C12
13	Quality Assurance, Monitoring & Teacher Accountability	AMES-003-P5-C13
14	Early Years Implementation Toolkit & Official Templates	AMES-003-P5-C14
15	Volume III Implementation & Compliance Declaration	AMES-003-P5-C15

CHAPTER 1 - THE AMES EARLY YEARS TEACHING MODEL

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C1 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

1. Purpose

A written curriculum does not automatically produce excellent education. Its quality depends on what happens between **CHILD ↔ ADULT ↔ ENVIRONMENT ↔ CURRICULUM**. Practitioners understand what, why and how they teach; what children should experience; how learning is recognised; and what happens next. Central question: **HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?**

2. The AMES Early Years Pedagogical Model

Eight interconnected elements: Secure Relationships; Rich Communication; Intentional Teaching; Purposeful Play; Prepared Environment; Practical Life; Observation & Responsive Assessment; Increasing Independence. Together: **SECURITY -> ENGAGEMENT -> EXPLORATION -> TEACHING -> PRACTICE -> APPLICATION -> REFLECTION -> INDEPENDENCE**.

3. Secure Relationships

Children learn best when safe, known, respected, valued and emotionally secure. Adults welcome personally, learn interests, listen, respond sensitively, model respect, provide predictable routines, recognise emotional needs and build family relationships. **SECURITY MAKES EXPLORATION POSSIBLE**.

4. The Role of the Adult

The practitioner is observer, communicator, teacher, model, questioner, storyteller, facilitator, assessor, protector and designer of learning opportunities, deciding professionally when to observe, join, model, explain, question, demonstrate, support, extend or withdraw.

5. Intentional Teaching

Play does not mean absence of teaching. Intentional teaching includes direct phonics, mathematical modelling, vocabulary, storytelling, Practical Life demonstration, tool/physical skill modelling, investigation, safety, shared reading/writing and guided discussion. It remains purposeful, developmentally appropriate, responsive and connected to practice/application.

6. Purposeful Play

High-quality play develops communication, negotiation, imagination, planning, counting, comparison, construction, problem-solving, writing, environmental reading, experimentation, cooperation, persistence, regulation and representation. Teachers examine learning possibilities, resources, language, thinking and whether intervention improves or interrupts play. **PLAY WITH PURPOSE - NOT PLAY FOR APPEARANCE**.

7. Adult-Led and Child-Initiated Learning

AMES uses both. Adult-led learning is especially important for systematic phonics, vocabulary, mathematics, safety, Practical Life demonstrations, physical techniques, explicit knowledge and selected stories/discussions. Child-initiated learning supports choice, application, creativity, problem-solving, social interaction, imagination, sustained investigation and independence. **TEACH -> PROVIDE -> OBSERVE -> EXTEND**.

8. The Prepared Environment

Montessori influence is visible in accessible, organised, purposeful, safe, attractive, developmentally appropriate and well-maintained resources. The environment communicates belonging, choice, independence and responsibility. Avoid unnecessary visual overload.

9. Continuous Provision

Age-appropriate continuous access includes books, mark-making/writing, mathematics, construction, small world, role play, creative arts, investigation, Practical Life, sensory/fine-motor experiences and outdoor learning; Reception increasingly includes purposeful technology. Provision evolves with development.

10. Enhancements

Themes enhance rather than replace provision. A transport theme can include vehicle construction, tickets/signs, distance comparison, transport-station role play, routes/journeys, vehicle design, outdoor obstacle journeys and fiction/non-fiction texts, preserving curriculum breadth.

11. Communication-Rich Teaching

Every practitioner is a language teacher: speak clearly, model rich vocabulary, extend sentences naturally, introduce precise words, allow processing time, encourage conversation, listen, read expressively and use songs/rhymes. Prefer genuine prompts such as 'Tell me about what you're making' and 'What could you try next?' over constant quizzing.

12. Questioning

Use closed questions for specific knowledge, open questions to extend thought, reflective prompts, predictive prompts, reasoning prompts and vocabulary prompts strategically. Not every interaction should become a quiz.

13. Scaffolding

Support may include modelling, gestures, visuals, sentence starters, task steps, working alongside, manipulatives, repetition, demonstration and thinking aloud. It reduces over time: **SUPPORT -> PRACTICE -> WITHDRAW -> INDEPENDENCE**.

14. Practical Life as Pedagogy

Practical Life develops concentration, coordination, sequence, fine motor, independence, responsibility, order, self-regulation and confidence through pouring, transferring, scooping, sorting, folding, cleaning, wiping, fastening, serving, carrying, organising and plant care. Progression: Crèche **DO WITH ME -> LET ME HELP -> LET ME TRY**; Nursery **I CAN DO MORE -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY -> I AM BECOMING INDEPENDENT**; Reception **I CAN MANAGE MYSELF AND MY LEARNING -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY FOR MY LEARNING ENVIRONMENT -> I AM READY TO TAKE GREATER RESPONSIBILITY**.

15. Literacy Implementation

Progression: **LISTEN -> TALK -> RHYME -> HEAR SOUNDS -> ENJOY BOOKS -> REPRESENT -> DECODE -> READ -> COMPOSE -> WRITE**. Crèche/Nursery are not judged by premature formal reading. Reception introduces systematic synthetic phonics while retaining literature, conversation, storytelling, rhymes, oral language and meaningful writing.

16. Mathematics Implementation

Progression: **EXPERIENCE -> NOTICE -> COMPARE -> REPRESENT -> REASON -> APPLY**. Mathematics arises through objects, movement, stories, games, construction, Practical Life, outdoors, songs, patterns and problems. Goal: mathematical thinking, not mere number recitation.

17. Understanding the World

Children experience observation, investigation, people, community, past/present, nature, materials, growth, weather, technology, places and culture. Knowledge widens: **SELF -> FAMILY -> SCHOOL -> OWO -> NIGERIA -> AFRICA -> WORLD**.

18. Expressive Arts & Design

Creative learning includes drawing, painting, modelling, construction, music, movement, dance, drama, storytelling, imaginative play and design. Avoid excessive identical adult-directed crafts; value children's explanations and individual representation.

19. Outdoor Pedagogy

Outdoor learning supports physical development, science, mathematics, communication, creativity, problem-solving, social development, environmental knowledge and wellbeing. Teachers plan learning outdoors, not merely supervision.

20. Observation

Ask what is happening, what it reveals, what the child may be learning, whether learning is secure/emerging and what happens next. Not every observation needs a photograph, long note or portfolio page.

21. Assessment

The official AMES overarching teaching cycle is **KNOW -> PLAN -> TEACH -> OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND -> REVIEW**. For focused observation, use **OBSERVE -> UNDERSTAND -> PLAN -> RESPOND**. Assessment influences interaction, planning, environment, grouping, intervention, resources and parent communication.

22. Planning

Planning begins with curriculum, current development, assessment, useful interests, misconceptions, seasonal/community opportunities and the school calendar. It balances structured progression with responsiveness.

23. The AMES Weekly Planning Cycle

Review what children learned; identify what must be taught; plan direct teaching; prepare provision; teach; observe application; respond by extending/revisiting/adapting; reflect on next steps. **CURRICULUM -> TEACHING -> EXPERIENCE -> ASSESSMENT -> NEXT STEP**.

24. Grouping

Use whole-class, small-group, pair, individual and child-selected collaboration according to learning purpose. No single grouping model is universally best.

25. Worksheets

Worksheets are not automatically forbidden but never dominate Early Years. First consider whether objects, conversation, movement, construction, books, investigation or meaningful writing offer richer learning. **THE NUMBER OF COMPLETED PAGES IS NOT A MEASURE OF CURRICULUM QUALITY**.

26. Behaviour and Discipline

Develop understanding, self-regulation, responsibility, repair and respect with clear boundaries and calm, consistent, firm, fair and respectful adults. Avoid humiliation, fear, public shaming, comparison and threats. Christian character is visible in adult authority.

27. Inclusion

Ask what adjustment helps the child access learning. Adjust communication, resources, time, environment, sensory/physical access, adult support, group size or presentation while maintaining high expectations.

28. Home Language and English

Value Yoruba and other home languages while providing rich English exposure. Distinguish learning English from language/learning difficulty; they are not automatically the same.

29. Christian Character in Pedagogy

Christian education is visible in speech, conflict handling, response to mistakes, support for vulnerable children, resource sharing, authority and environmental care. Develop love, kindness, respect, gratitude, responsibility, service, patience, perseverance, gentleness, stewardship, wisdom, fairness, courage and hope.

30. What an AMES Early Years Classroom Should Feel Like

Children talk, listen, read/look at books, build, count, investigate, draw, write, move, create, cooperate, choose, solve problems, help and take responsibility. Adults teach, observe, question, model, read, listen, extend and support. The classroom is **CALM - PURPOSEFUL - WARM - ACTIVE - ORDERED - CURIOUS - CHILD-CENTRED**.

31. The AMES Teacher Reflection Test

Teachers ask what they intended, what happened, who understood/needs support, whether adult talk dominated, whether thinking time was sufficient, whether questions deepened learning, whether the environment helped, whether children applied learning independently and what changes tomorrow.

32. Non-Negotiable Early Years Practices

Children are treated with dignity; safeguarding comes first; spoken language is developed; books are daily; songs/rhymes remain important; Reception phonics is systematic; mathematics prioritises understanding; play is purposeful; Practical Life develops independence; outdoors is curriculum; continuous provision remains; Christian character is modelled; Nigerian identity is authentic; Africa is accurate/diverse; SEND receives support; assessment informs teaching; parents are partners; responsibility increases; worksheets never define quality; teachers continually ask **HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?**

33. AMES Implementation Declaration

We will know and listen to our children; teach deliberately; allow exploration; model, question, explain, read, sing, count, investigate, build, create and go outdoors; prepare usable environments; give responsibility; allow attempts and mistakes; observe and assess proportionately; respond, adapt and remove barriers; work with families; protect childhood; develop independence; and live Christian values. **THE AMES CURRICULUM WILL BE VISIBLE IN WHAT CHILDREN EXPERIENCE EVERY DAY. IN GOD WE TRUST.**

CHAPTER 2 - EARLY YEARS PLANNING FRAMEWORK

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C2 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Purpose

Planning ensures curriculum intentions become meaningful experiences. It answers what children learn, what they know, how the next learning is taught, how it is practised/applied and how next steps are identified. Planning operates within the official AMES cycle: **KNOW -> PLAN -> TEACH -> OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND -> REVIEW. PLANNING EXISTS TO IMPROVE TEACHING.**

Four Levels of Planning

Level 1 Yearly Curriculum; Level 2 Termly Implementation Plan; Level 3 Weekly Plan; Level 4 Daily Responsive Teaching. Crèche remains highly responsive; Nursery becomes increasingly structured while protecting play; Reception explicitly sequences phonics, reading, writing, mathematics and knowledge while maintaining full EYFS and continuous provision.

Weekly Planning Requirements

Record class, week, term, teacher, Big Idea, curriculum intent, prior learning, vocabulary, core texts, Christian character, all prime/specific areas, Practical Life, outdoors, purposeful technology, Nigerian/Owo context, SEND/access adjustments, assessment focus, resources, parent/home connection and reflection.

Continuous Provision Planning

Identify what remains continuously available and what weekly enhancement deepens curriculum. Themes must not destroy established provision.

Planning for SEND

Record meaningful adjustments rather than labels. Ask **WHAT WILL HELP THIS CHILD ACCESS THIS LEARNING?**

Planning Non-Negotiables

Follow approved curriculum; reflect current learning; include all EYFS areas over time; protect play; include language, books, outdoors, Practical Life, assessment priorities and inclusion; remain responsive without excessive paperwork.

CHAPTER 3 - ASSESSMENT, OBSERVATION & EVIDENCE FRAMEWORK

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C3 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Purpose

Assessment asks what the child can do, what is emerging, what is getting in the way and what should be taught next. For focused observation use **OBSERVE -> UNDERSTAND -> PLAN -> RESPOND**, within the overarching AMES teaching cycle.

Assessment Types

Initial/baseline understanding; formative assessment; focused assessment; summative review; and Reception end-of-year assessment where AMES uses the EYFS Profile/ELGs as a British-system reference. English statutory requirements are not Nigerian statutory requirements.

Evidence

Evidence includes what children say/do, reading, writing, reasoning, independent application, practical work, construction, art, observation and relevant parent information. **THE CHILD'S LEARNING IS THE EVIDENCE - NOT THE SIZE OF THE PORTFOLIO.**

Observation Record

Child; Date; Context; Observation; What this tells us; Curriculum connection; Possible next response; Follow-up required.

Assessment and Planning

Assessment must change teaching. A child recognising graphemes but not blending should receive increased oral/cumulative word-blending practice rather than repeated documentation.

Progress Concerns

NOTICE -> CHECK -> ADAPT -> SUPPORT -> REVIEW -> ESCALATE WHERE NECESSARY. Consider attendance, language exposure, hearing/vision, instruction, development, environment, SEND, wellbeing and relevant family context. Teachers do not diagnose outside competence.

Assessment Workload

Avoid photographs of everything, repeated evidence of secure learning, extensive copied descriptions and evidence purely for display.

CHAPTER 4 - LEARNING ENVIRONMENT & CONTINUOUS PROVISION STANDARDS

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C4 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Environment Principle

THE ENVIRONMENT IS PART OF THE TEACHING TEAM. It promotes independence, communication, choice, concentration, exploration, order, creativity and responsibility.

Core Provision

Reading; Communication/Storytelling; Mark Making/Writing; Mathematics; Construction; Small World; Role Play; Creative Arts; Investigation; Practical Life; Fine Motor/Sensory; Outdoor Learning; and purposeful technology in Reception where appropriate.

Resource Standards

Resources are safe, accessible, clean, complete, organised, purposeful, inclusive and developmentally appropriate. Children increasingly restore materials.

Displays

Displays communicate learning, celebrate authentic child work, support vocabulary/reference and represent diversity. **A BUSY WALL IS NOT NECESSARILY A RICH ENVIRONMENT.**

Cultural Representation

Authentically represent Owo, Ondo State, Nigeria, Africa, wider world, varied families, occupations, abilities and communities. Africa is not a single culture.

Environment Audit

Check accessibility, choice, restoration, books, writing, manipulable mathematics, construction, investigation, Practical Life, cultural authenticity, SEND access, clutter and independence.

CHAPTER 5 - PHONICS, READING, WRITING & LANGUAGE IMPLEMENTATION

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C5 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Language First

LISTEN -> SPEAK -> UNDERSTAND -> ENJOY LANGUAGE -> HEAR SOUNDS -> DECODE -> READ -> COMPOSE -> WRITE.

Crèche and Nursery

Prioritise conversation, stories, rhymes, songs, sound awareness, vocabulary, book enjoyment, mark-making, fine motor and oral storytelling; do not push formal reading prematurely.

Reception Phonics

Use the adopted systematic synthetic phonics programme consistently: GPCs, oral blending, word blending, segmenting, spelling, cumulative review, programme-aligned tricky/common exception words and decodable reading.

Decodable Books

Independent phonics-practice books closely match taught knowledge. Children are not trained to guess unknown words from pictures; pictures support meaning/discussion/enjoyment.

Reading Aloud

Adults read high-quality literature daily. **BOOKS THEY CAN READ + BOOKS THEY CAN EXPERIENCE.**

Writing

THINK -> SAY -> REHEARSE -> SEGMENT -> WRITE -> READ BACK -> IMPROVE. Use meaningful purposes such as messages, lists, captions, stories, instructions, information and labels.

Handwriting

Teach posture, grip, paper position, movement, formation, orientation, spacing and control. **QUALITY BEFORE QUANTITY.**

Reading Tracker

Record child, programme point, GPCs, blending, segmenting, matched book sequence, fluency, comprehension, support and next review.

CHAPTER 6 - MATHEMATICS IMPLEMENTATION FRAMEWORK

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C6 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Mathematical Philosophy

UNDERSTANDING BEFORE ACCELERATION.

Progression

EXPERIENCE -> MANIPULATE -> NOTICE -> TALK -> REPRESENT -> REASON -> APPLY.

Experiences

Counting, subitising, cardinality, composition, comparison, pattern, relationships, shape, space, measure, construction, Practical Life, songs, stories, movement, games and problems.

Language

Model more, fewer, equal, same, different, part, whole, longer, shorter, heavier, lighter, full, empty, above, below, between, before and after.

Manipulatives

Children touch, move, group, separate, compare, rearrange and represent; removing manipulatives too early can hide understanding.

Questioning

How do you know? Can you show another way? What changed/stayed the same? Which has more? How could we check? Is there another possibility?

Assessment

Assess understanding, representation, language, transfer and reasoning, not solely written pages.

CHAPTER 7 - PRACTICAL LIFE, INDEPENDENCE & MONTESSORI INTEGRATION

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C7 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Purpose

AMES integrates selected Montessori principles intentionally. Practical Life supports order, coordination, concentration, independence, responsibility, fine motor, self-regulation and care.

Progression

Crèche: **DO WITH ME -> LET ME HELP -> LET ME TRY.** Nursery: **I CAN DO MORE -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY -> I AM BECOMING INDEPENDENT.** Reception: **I CAN MANAGE MYSELF AND MY LEARNING -> I CAN TAKE RESPONSIBILITY FOR MY LEARNING ENVIRONMENT -> I AM READY TO TAKE GREATER RESPONSIBILITY.**

Experiences

Pouring, transferring, scooping, sorting, folding, fastening, wiping, sweeping, serving, carrying, organising, washing, plant care, resource care and self-care.

Montessori Lesson Principle

PREPARE -> DEMONSTRATE -> INVITE -> OBSERVE -> WITHDRAW -> REPEAT -> MASTER.

Independence Test

Before helping ask: Can the child attempt this safely? Adult efficiency should not routinely replace child learning.

CHAPTER 8 - INCLUSION, SEND & MULTILINGUAL LEARNERS

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C8 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Inclusion Principle

ACCESS BEFORE ASSUMPTION. Difference does not automatically mean deficit.

Early Identification

Notice persistent barriers in communication, interaction, physical development, sensory processing, attention, learning, self-regulation and independence; document/discuss through appropriate support processes.

Graduated Response

IDENTIFY -> ADAPT -> SUPPORT -> REVIEW -> SEEK FURTHER PROFESSIONAL GUIDANCE where necessary.

Classroom Adjustments

Visual schedules, simplified instructions, pre-teaching, repetition, adapted tools, sensory breaks, processing time, smaller groups, alternative communication, manipulatives and seating/environment changes.

Multilingual Learners

Yoruba and other home languages are assets. Provide rich English interaction while respecting linguistic identity; limited English is not automatically SEND.

SEND Support Record

Child; Barrier; Strengths; Adjustment; Target; Responsible adult; Start date; Review date; Impact; Next action.

CHAPTER 9 - SAFEGUARDING, WELLBEING, BEHAVIOUR & PSED

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C9 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Safeguarding

Safeguarding underpins every activity. Staff follow school child-protection/safeguarding policies and applicable Nigerian requirements; curriculum documentation does not replace formal procedures.

Child Dignity

No humiliation, degrading punishment, public shaming, threats for mistakes or ridicule of developmental differences.

Behaviour

Develop boundaries, routines, empathy, responsibility, repair, self-regulation and respect through explanation, modelling, reminders, redirection, support, appropriate consequences and relationship repair.

PSED

Children learn to recognise feelings, express needs, wait, take turns, cooperate, resolve simple disagreements, persist, recover from disappointment, seek help and develop relationships. **SELF-REGULATION IS NOT SILENT COMPLIANCE.**

Christian Character

Love, kindness, respect, honesty, service, gratitude, patience, perseverance, stewardship, wisdom, courage and forgiveness. Faith strengthens dignity rather than humiliation.

CHAPTER 10 - OUTDOOR LEARNING, PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT & HEALTH

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C10 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Outdoor Curriculum

Outdoor learning supports gross motor, communication, science, mathematics, creativity, problem-solving, social development, environmental knowledge and wellbeing.

Outdoor Experiences

Running, safe climbing, balancing, throwing, catching, routes, large construction, water/sand where available, planting, weather, nature observation, measurement, phonics trails, storytelling and games.

Fine Motor

Threading, fastening, peg work, construction, malleable materials, cutting, drawing, painting, Practical Life and writing; fine motor precedes excessive handwriting demands.

Health and Self-Care

Handwashing, toileting, oral-health awareness, food, water, rest, movement, personal hygiene and safe choices.

Physical Safety

Risk assessment, supervision, safe equipment, boundaries, first-aid readiness and individual needs. Risk is managed, not eliminated so completely that competence cannot develop.

CHAPTER 11 - PARENT PARTNERSHIP & HOME LEARNING FRAMEWORK

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C11 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Principle

PARENTS ARE PARTNERS - NOT HOMEWORK SUPERVISORS FOR A SECOND SCHOOL DAY.

Parent Communication

Meetings, reports, portal/app, website, messages, workshops, reading records and notices; communication is respectful and understandable.

Parent Workshops

EYFS, Montessori integration, phonics, reading, writing, mathematics, independence, behaviour/self-regulation, online safety where appropriate and Reception-to-Basic-1 transition.

Home Learning

Reading, conversation, songs, rhymes, counting, shopping mathematics, cooking, sorting, helping, drawing, meaningful writing, outdoors and games.

Reception Reading at Home

Teach parents sound pronunciation, blending, matched decodables, avoiding guessing and continuing rich read-alouds.

Parent Meeting Record

Child; Date; Attendees; Strengths; Current development; Parent information/concerns; School actions; Home actions; Review date.

CHAPTER 12 - RECEPTION-TO-BASIC-1 TRANSITION & SCHOOL READINESS

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C12 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Transition Principle

PREPARE THE CHILD FOR BASIC 1 - DO NOT TURN RECEPTION INTO BASIC 1.

School Readiness

Communication, self-regulation, relationships, physical development, self-care, phonics foundations, reading, writing, mathematics, curiosity, attention, independence and responsibility; not worksheet completion.

Transition Experiences

Where practical visit Basic 1, meet teacher, explore classroom/resources, experience a short activity, ask questions, discuss feelings and involve parents.

Transition Profile

Communication & Language; PSED; Physical Development; Literacy; Mathematics; Understanding the World; Expressive Arts; Practical Life; SEND/adjustments; Child Voice.

Teacher Handover

Discuss phonics, reading, writing, mathematics, language, PSED, independence, strengths, SEND, successful strategies, medical information via proper procedures and relevant safeguarding information confidentially. **KNOW WHERE THEY ARE -> CONTINUE THE JOURNEY.**

CHAPTER 13 - QUALITY ASSURANCE, MONITORING & TEACHER ACCOUNTABILITY

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C13 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Purpose

Quality assurance asks: **IS THE APPROVED CURRICULUM ACTUALLY HAPPENING FOR CHILDREN?** It is not intended to create fear or unnecessary paperwork.

Leadership Monitoring

Learning walks, observation, planning review, environment audit, work sampling where appropriate, phonics/reading review, assessment discussion, teacher conversation, child voice, parent feedback and transition review.

Learning-Walk Questions

Engagement; learning; language; adult interaction; books; mathematics; continuous provision; Practical Life; independence; SEND adjustments; authentic Nigerian/African representation; purposeful outdoor learning.

Teacher Observation

Examine subject knowledge, interaction, explanation, modelling, questioning, responsiveness, inclusion, assessment, environment use, behaviour and engagement; one lesson is not the complete measure of teacher quality.

Improvement Cycle

MONITOR -> IDENTIFY -> SUPPORT -> IMPLEMENT -> REVIEW.

Teacher Accountability

Teachers know curriculum, plan, prepare, teach, safeguard, assess proportionately, respond, communicate, maintain required records and reflect. Leadership provides resources, training, support, time, expectations and feedback.

CHAPTER 14 - EARLY YEARS IMPLEMENTATION TOOLKIT & OFFICIAL TEMPLATES

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C14 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

The following forms preserve the approved information fields but use a staff-friendly layout with readable labels and writing space.

Template A. Termly Implementation Overview

Class	
Term	
Teacher	
Weeks	
Big Idea / Curriculum Intent	
Core Knowledge	
Key Vocabulary	
Literacy / Phonics	
Mathematics	
Understanding the World / EAD	
Practical Life	
Christian Character	
Assessment Priorities	

Template B. Weekly Curriculum Plan

Class / Week / Term / Teacher	
Big Idea	
Prior Learning	
Curriculum Intent	
Key Vocabulary	
Core Text	
Phonics / Literacy	
Mathematics	
Communication & Language	
PSED	
Physical Development	
Understanding the World	
Expressive Arts & Design	
Practical Life	
Outdoor Learning	
Continuous-Provision Enhancements	
SEND / Access Adjustments	
Assessment Focus	
Resources	
Parent / Home Connection	
Reflection / Next Steps	

Template C. Daily Responsive Teaching Record

Date	
Planned Teaching	
What Happened	
Children Requiring Revisit	
Children Ready for Extension	
Unexpected Learning / Interest	
Adjustment for Tomorrow	

Template D. Focused Observation

Child	
Date / Context	
Objective Observation	
What This Tells Us	
Curriculum Connection	
Planned Response	
Follow-Up	

Template E. Intervention Record

Child / Group	
Area / Identified Need	
Intervention	
Frequency / Responsible Adult	
Baseline	
Review Date	
Impact	
Continue / Adapt / End / Escalate	

Template F. Reception Phonics & Reading Tracker

Child	
Programme Point	
GPC Recall	
Blending	
Segmenting	
Decodable Reading	
Fluency	
Comprehension	
Support / Next Step	
Review Date	

Template G. Continuous-Provision Audit

Area	
Purpose	
Core Resources	
Accessibility / Independence	
Current Enhancement	
Observed Learning	
Resources to Replace	
Next Improvement	

Template H. Parent Partnership Record

Child / Parent-Carer	
Date / Purpose	
Strengths	
Current Development / Concerns	
Parent Voice	
School Action	
Home Action	
Review Date	

Template I. SEND / Access Record

Child	
Strengths	
Barrier to Access	
Adjustment	
Target	
Responsible Adult	
Review Date	
Impact	
Next Action	

Template J. Reception-to-Basic-1 Transition Profile

Child	
Communication & Language	
PSED	
Physical Development	
Phonics / Reading	
Writing	
Mathematics	
Understanding the World	
Expressive Arts	
Practical Life / Independence	
SEND / Adjustments	
Interests / Strengths	
Successful Strategies	
Child Voice	
Parent Information	
Reception Teacher / Basic 1 Teacher	
Handover Date	

Template K. Teacher Self-Evaluation

Teacher / Class / Date	
Curriculum Knowledge	
Planning	
Communication-Rich Teaching	
Phonics (where applicable)	
Mathematics	
Continuous Provision	
Practical Life	
Outdoor Learning	
Assessment	
Inclusion	
Behaviour / PSED	
Parent Partnership	
Professional Development Priority	

Template L. Leadership Learning Walk

Date / Class / Observer	
Curriculum Focus	
Evidence of Purposeful Learning	
Adult Interaction / Language	
Books / Literacy	
Mathematics	
Independence / Practical Life	
Continuous Provision	
Inclusion / SEND	
Behaviour / Character	
Cultural Representation	
Outdoor Learning	
Strengths	
Development Priority	
Action / Responsible Person	
Review Date	

Template M. Classroom Environment Audit

Safety / Organisation	
Accessibility / Child Choice	
Books / Reading	
Writing / Mark Making	
Mathematics	
Construction / Small World / Role Play	
Investigation / Creative Arts	
Practical Life / Fine Motor	
Cultural Representation	
SEND Access	
Outdoor Provision	
Child Independence	
Priority Improvement	
Deadline / Review	

Template N. Curriculum Implementation Audit

Curriculum Sequence Followed	
All EYFS Areas Represented	
Reception Phonics Systematic	
Reading Books Appropriately Matched	
Rich Literature Available	
Writing Meaningful	
Mathematics Taught for Depth	
Practical Life Implemented	
Continuous Provision Maintained	
Outdoor Curriculum Active	
Nigerian Identity Authentic	
Africa Represented Accurately	
SEND Access Evident	
Assessment Informing Teaching	
Parent Partnership Functioning	
Transition Arrangements Effective	

CHAPTER 15 - VOLUME III IMPLEMENTATION & COMPLIANCE DECLARATION

Document Code: AMES-003-P5-C15 | Status: APPROVED & LOCKED

Purpose

Volume III is the official AMES Early Years curriculum and implementation framework for **CRÈCHE -> NURSERY -> RECEPTION**.

Four-Layer Framework

A. EYFS for England: principal educational reference for the school's British-system Early Years programme. **B. AMES School Requirements:** internal standards adopted by Angel Montessori School. **C. Montessori-Informed Practice:** selected principles deliberately incorporated. **D. Nigerian/Owo Context:** contextualisation ensuring children understand community, country and African identity. **INTEGRATION DOES NOT MEAN CONFUSION.**

Staff Responsibilities

Know curriculum/progression; plan from curriculum; teach intentionally; protect purposeful play; develop communication; use books; develop mathematical thinking; implement Practical Life and continuous provision; include outdoors; assess proportionately; support inclusion; safeguard; communicate with parents; reflect professionally.

Leadership Responsibilities

Provide curriculum access, training, resources, monitoring, improvement support, protection from unnecessary paperwork, assessment review, safeguarding systems, SEND support, transition and periodic curriculum review.

Curriculum Fidelity

Teachers may adapt examples, resources, questions, stories, enhancements, grouping, scaffolding and local opportunities but should not independently remove/fundamentally alter major progression. **RESPONSIVE TEACHING IS EXPECTED. CURRICULUM DRIFT IS NOT.**

Annual Review

Review what worked, difficulties, realism of progression, resources, assessment, teacher/parent feedback, SEND and transition. Formal revisions receive version number, approval date, authorisation and document record.

Implementation Cycle

Use the official overarching AMES cycle: **KNOW -> PLAN -> TEACH -> OBSERVE -> INTERPRET -> RESPOND -> REVIEW**, supported by leadership monitoring and continuous improvement.

Final Part V Declaration

The AMES Early Years curriculum will not remain on a shelf. It will live in teacher planning, adult language, books, decoding, composition, mathematical reasoning, questions, construction, investigation, songs, stories, movement, practical work, choices, responsibility, relationships and care for the environment.

We will not measure quality by paperwork, confuse pressure with high expectations, choose between British Early Years practice and Nigerian identity, use Montessori merely as a label, allow assessment to replace teaching, or allow transition to Basic 1 to erase Reception.

HIGH EXPECTATIONS + APPROPRIATE DEVELOPMENT

HOW DOES THIS HELP THE CHILD FLOURISH?

IN GOD WE TRUST.

Version 1.1 Audit Record

Package: AMES Volume III - Part V, Chapters 1-15

Version: 1.1

Basis: Approved v1.0 records with final-audit corrections

Key corrections: full Chapter 1 restoration; AMES cycle harmonisation; EYFS legal-status clarification; Chapter 14 template redesign; framework wording standardisation.

Master Compilation Status: READY FOR FINAL VOLUME III COMPILATION